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JUDAH K. LEFKOVITS

# THE COPPER SCROLL

## 3Q15: A REEVALUATION

*A New Reading, Translation, and Commentary*





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THE COPPER SCROLL - 3Q15: A REEVALUATION

# STUDIES ON THE TEXTS OF THE DESERT OF JUDAH

EDITED BY

F. GARCÍA MARTÍNEZ  
A. S. VAN DER WOUDE

VOLUME XXV



488  
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2000

# THE COPPER SCROLL

## 3Q15: A REEVALUATION

*A New Reading, Translation, and Commentary*

BY

JUDAH K. LEFKOVITS



BRILL  
LEIDEN · BOSTON · KÖLN  
2000

This book is printed on acid-free paper.

**Die Deutsche Bibliothek – CIP-Einheitsaufnahme**

**Lefkovits, Judah K.:**

The copper scroll – 3Q15 : a reevaluation : a new reading, translation, and commentary / by Judah K. Lefkovits. – Leiden ; Boston ; Köln : Brill, 1999

(Studies on the texts of the desert of Judah ; Vol. 25)

ISBN 90-04-10685-5

**Library of Congress Cataloging-in-Publication Data**

Library of Congress Cataloging-in-Publication Data is also available

Theology Library  
SCHOOL OF THEOLOGY  
AT CLAREMONT  
California

ISSN 0169-9962

ISBN 90 04 10685 5

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PRINTED IN THE NETHERLANDS

ב"ה

This book is respectfully dedicated to  
my late father

MIKSA LEFKOVITS

אבי מורי מו"ה מרדכי בן מוה"ר מאיר חיים ע"ה

my late mother

KATÓ LEFKOVITS nee KAUFMANN

אמי מורתי מרת גאלי בת מוה"ר יהודה ע"ה

who risked their lives to save others during the Holocaust,

my late uncle

ROBERT LEFKOVITS

מו"ה ראובן דוב בן מוה"ר מאיר חיים ע"ה

who helped save our lives during the war,

my late aunt

BELLA BERNSTEIN nee KAUFMANN

מרת ברכה בת מוה"ר יהודה ע"ה

who was like a mother to us,

our deceased relatives

SAMUEL REICHMANN and his wife RENÉE nee GESTETNER

מו"ה שמעיהו בן מו"ה דוד ע"ה ומרת רבקה בת מוה"ר אברהם ע"ה

and their talented daughter

ÉVA MÉDI HELLER - GUTWIRTH

מרת פינקל בת שמעיהו ע"ה

who helped save our lives and that of many others during the war,

my late revered teacher and mentor

RABBI BERNÁT MOSKOVITS (RAPPAPORT)

אדמו"ר הרב ברוך צבי בן מוה"ר דוד הכהן זצ"ל

Dean of the Yeshivah Benei David and Chief Rabbi of Paks, Hungary,

who risked his life to teach Torah during the dark age of Communism,

then held rabbinical positions in Budapest, Vienna, and Brooklyn,

and who authored more than two dozen volumes in Rabbinics,

and his wife

JOLÁN nee KRAUS

הרבנית ייטל בת מוה"ר זאב ע"ה

ת' נ' צ' ב' ה'

As a survivor of the Holocaust, I feel especially obligated to also dedicate  
this book to the memory of the six million Jews who perished during World  
War II, which included hundreds of members of my immediate family.

השם ינקום דמם



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## ACKNOWLEDGMENTS

This book is a comprehensive revision of my dissertation entitled *The Copper Scroll — 3Q15, A New Reading, Translation and Commentary*, submitted in partial fulfillment of the requirements for the degree of Doctor of Philosophy to the Department of Near Eastern Languages and Literatures, Graduate School of Arts and Sciences, New York University, in September 1993.

I wish to express my gratitude to Prof. Lawrence H. Schiffman (New York University), who suggested the thesis topic, served as my mentor, and facilitated publication of this work; to Prof. Frank Peters (New York University), who accepted me as a student in the department, was helpful in securing new photographs of the Copper Scroll from the Museum of Amman, Jordan, and advised me organizing the dissertation; to Prof. Baruch A. Levine (New York University), with whom I took most of my graduate courses; to Prof. Cyrus H. Gordon (New York University), who enthusiastically supported the initiation of this project; to the late Prof. Jonas C. Greenfield (Hebrew University), for his advice at the early stage of this study, and finally to my brother-in-law, Prof. Saul Wischnitzer (Long Island University), who encouraged me, offered many valuable suggestions, and helped edit this work.

In addition, I want to acknowledge Mr. Magen Broshi (Shrine of the Book, Jerusalem) and the late Pierre P. Benoit (École Biblique et Archéologique Française, Jerusalem), for facilitating my securing photographs of the Copper Scroll from the negatives of those published in Milik's work, located at the Rockefeller Museum in Jerusalem; Prof. Bruce Zuckerman (University of Southern California) and Prof. James H. Charlesworth (Princeton Theological Seminary), who allowed me to study some of their magnificent photographs of the Copper Scroll taken at the Museum of Amman; Prof. George J. Brooke (University of Manchester), for his invitation to participate in the *International Symposium on the Copper Scroll* at the University of Manchester, September 8-10, 1996, and for introducing me to Mrs. Joan R. Allegro, the widow of John Marco Allegro, who kindly sent me copies of unpublished material by her husband, written immediately after the opening of the Copper Scroll in 1956-57, which has been largely incorporated in this work; for Prof. Florentino Garcia Martinez (Rijks-universiteit Groningen), for important publishing advice, and accepting my manuscript in the series *Studies on the Texts of the Desert of Judah* under his editorship. I am also grateful to Ms. Mattie Kuiper, Desk Editor for Religious Studies, E.J. Brill, for her cooperation during the extended time needed to prepare this work.

Preparation of this study was supported in part by a predoctoral grant from the Abraham Kittay Fellowship at New York University, and pre- and post-doctoral grants from the Memorial Foundation for Jewish Culture.



## ABBREVIATIONS

|                                          |                                                                                              |
|------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| A                                        | <i>Aramaic</i>                                                                               |
| ABD                                      | <i>Anchor Bible Dictionary</i>                                                               |
| AC                                       | Kohut: <i>Aruch Completum</i>                                                                |
| ACC                                      | Krauss: <i>Addimenta Aruch Completum</i>                                                     |
| Allegro                                  | <i>The Treasury of the Copper Scroll</i> (first ed.)                                         |
| Allegro <sup>dr</sup> or A <sup>dr</sup> | Allegro's drawing of the Copper Scroll                                                       |
| Allegro <sup>pr</sup>                    | The original part of "Allegro's Provisional Translation and Notes on the Copper Scroll" (MS) |
| Allegro <sup>rev</sup>                   | <i>The Treasury of the Copper Scroll</i> (rev. ed.)                                          |
| Allegro <sup>pr</sup>                    | Revision within "Allegro's Provisional Translation and Notes on the Copper Scroll" (MS)      |
| alt.                                     | alternate reading                                                                            |
| ANET                                     | Pritchard: <i>Ancient Near Eastern Texts</i>                                                 |
| ANYAS                                    | <i>Annals of the New York Academy of Sciences</i>                                            |
| "Apocalyptic"                            | Wolters: "Apocalyptic and the Copper Scroll"                                                 |
| Archive                                  | Kutscher - Kaddari: <i>Archive of the New Dictionary ...</i>                                 |
| ASOR                                     | <i>The American Schools of Oriental Research</i>                                             |
| b.                                       | Babylonian Talmud (followed by the Tractate)                                                 |
| BA                                       | Biblical Aramaic                                                                             |
| BA                                       | <i>Biblical Archaeologist</i>                                                                |
| Baker <sup>dr</sup> or B <sup>dr</sup>   | Baker's drawing in <i>DJD III</i>                                                            |
| BAR                                      | <i>Biblical Archaeology Review</i>                                                           |
| bar or ben                               | "son of"                                                                                     |
| BASOR                                    | <i>Bulletin of the American Schools of Oriental Research</i>                                 |
| BDB                                      | Brown, Driver, and Briggs: <i>Hebrew and English Lexicon of the Old Testament</i>            |
| Bendavid                                 | <i>Biblical Hebrew and Mishnaic Hebrew</i> (Heb.)                                            |
| <i>Beth She'arim 1</i>                   | by B. Mazar                                                                                  |
| <i>Beth She'arim 2</i>                   | by M. Schwabe and B. Lifshitz                                                                |
| <i>Beth She'arim 3</i>                   | by N. Avigad                                                                                 |
| Beyer                                    | <i>Die aramäischen Texte vom Toten Meer</i>                                                  |
| BH                                       | Biblical Hebrew                                                                              |
| Bibl.                                    | Bibliography                                                                                 |
| BJRL                                     | <i>Bulletin of the John Rylands Library</i>                                                  |
| BTA                                      | Babylonian Talmudic Aramaic                                                                  |
| BY                                       | Ben-Yehuda: <i>A Complete Dictionary of Ancient and Modern Hebrew</i>                        |
| BZ                                       | <i>Biblische Zeitschrift</i>                                                                 |
| Cowley                                   | <i>Aramaic Papyri of the Fifth Century B.C.</i>                                              |
| CS                                       | Copper Scroll                                                                                |
| CTL                                      | Brand: <i>Ceramics in Talmudic Literature</i>                                                |

- “David J. Wilmot and  
the Copper Scroll”  
*DJD*  
*DJDJ*  
*EB*  
*EB<sup>E</sup>*  
*EH*  
*EI*  
*EJ*  
*ESH<sup>con</sup>*  
*ESH<sup>dic</sup>*  
*ET*  
*ET<sup>E</sup>*  
*ETG*  
*ETGL*
- Frag.  
 Garcia Martinez  
 Gordis  
 Greenberg  
 Greenfield  
 H  
 Harkavy  
 “He‘arah”  
 “He‘arah le‘Iyyunim”  
 “History”  
*HR*  
*HUCA*  
*IDB*  
 “Hiddah”
- “Identification”
- IEJ*  
 “‘Iyyunim”  
*JA*  
*JAOS*  
 Jastrow
- JBL*  
*JE*  
*JJS*  
*JNES*  
*JPOS*  
*JPS<sup>i</sup>*  
*JPS<sup>ii</sup>*
- by Wise  
*Discoveries in the Judaean Desert*  
*Discoveries in the Judaean Desert of Jordan*  
*Encyclopaedia Biblica*  
*Encyclopaedia Biblica* (Eng.)  
*Encyclopaedia Hebraica*  
*Eretz Israel*  
*Encyclopaedia Judaica* (Eng.)  
 Even-Shoshan: *A New Concordance of the Bible* (Heb.)  
 Even-Shoshan: *HamMillon heHadaš*  
*Talmudic Encyclopedia* (Heb.)  
*Encyclopedia Talmudica* (Eng.)  
 Neaman: *Encyclopedia of Talmudical Geography*  
 Margalioth: *Encyclopedia of the Talmudic and Geonic Literature* (Heb.)
- Fragmentary Targum  
*The Dead Sea Scroll Translated*  
*The Biblical Text in the Making*  
*Foreign Words in the Bible Commentary of Rashi*  
 “The Small Caves of Qumran”  
 Hebrew  
*Students’ Hebrew and Chaldee Dictionary*  
 Qimron: “הערה למאמרו של גד בן-עמי צרפתי”  
 Sharvit: “הערה ל‘עיונים במילונה של מגילת הנחושת”  
 Wolters: “History and the Copper Scroll”  
 Avinery: *Heichal Rashi*  
*Hebrew Union College Annual*  
*The Interpreter’s Dictionary of the Bible*  
 Sarfati: “בתכן אצלם” — חידה מן החירות של מגילת הנחושת  
 Lehmann: “Identification of the Copper Scroll Based on its Technical Terms”  
*Israel Exploration Journal*  
 Sharvit: “עיונים במילונה של מגילת הנחושת”  
 Judeo-Aramaic  
*Journal of the American Oriental Society*  
*A Dictionary of the Targumim, the Talmud Babli and Yerushalmi, and the Midrashic Literature*  
*Journal of Biblical Literature*  
*Jewish Encyclopedia*  
*Journal of Jewish Studies*  
*Journal of Near Eastern Studies*  
*The Journal of the Palestinian Oriental Society*  
*The Holy Scriptures* (old ed.)  
*Tanakh — The Holy Scriptures* (new ed.)

|                                        |                                                                            |
|----------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <i>JQR</i>                             | <i>Jewish Quarterly Review</i>                                             |
| <i>JSJ</i>                             | <i>Journal for the Study of Judaism</i>                                    |
| <i>JSS</i>                             | <i>Journal of Semitic Studies</i>                                          |
| <i>KAI</i>                             | Donner - Röllig: <i>Kanaanäische und Aramäische Inschriften</i>            |
| Karo                                   | <i>Millon Talmudi</i>                                                      |
| <i>ketiv</i> or כּ                     | כֶּתִיב, how it is written in the Masoretic Text.                          |
| Kraeling                               | <i>The Brooklyn Museum Aramaic Papyri</i>                                  |
| KS                                     | Krupnik-Silbermann: <i>A Dictionary of the Talmud ...</i>                  |
| Lefkovits <sup>diss</sup>              | <i>The Copper Scroll — 3Q15: A New Reading, Translation and Commentary</i> |
| <i>LLBIS</i>                           | Kutscher: <i>The Language ... of the Isaiah Scroll</i> (Heb.)              |
| Lurie                                  | <i>Megillot hanNehošet mimMidbar Yehudah</i>                               |
| m.                                     | Mishnah (followed by the Tractate)                                         |
| McCarter                               | "The Copper Scroll Treasure as an Accumulation ..."                        |
| <i>MGWJ</i>                            | <i>Monatschrift für Geschichte und Wissenschaft des Judentums</i>          |
| Milik                                  | Milik's edition of the Copper Scroll in <i>DJD III</i>                     |
| Milik <sup>dr</sup> or M <sup>dr</sup> | Milik's drawing in <i>DJD III</i>                                          |
| Milik <sup>E</sup>                     | "The Copper Document from Cave III of Qumran ..."                          |
| Milik <sup>ET</sup>                    | "Notes d'Epigraphie et de Topographie Palestiniennes"                      |
| Milik <sup>F</sup>                     | "Le Rouleau de Cuivre de Qumrân"                                           |
| Milik <sup>org</sup>                   | Milik's original reading prior his official edition                        |
| MK                                     | Mandelkern: <i>Concordance on the Bible</i> (Heb.)                         |
| MMT or 4QMMT                           | Miqsat Ma'aseh hatTorah                                                    |
| <i>MNM</i>                             | Epstein: <i>Mavo' leNosaḥ hamMišnah</i>                                    |
| Moscatti                               | <i>Introduction to Comparative Grammar of the Semitic Languages</i>        |
| MT                                     | Masoretic Text                                                             |
| "Mysterious"                           | McCarter: "The Mysterious Copper Scroll"                                   |
| "Mystery <sup>i</sup> "                | McCarter: "The Mystery of the Copper Scroll" (1991)                        |
| "Mystery <sup>ii</sup> "               | McCarter: "The Mystery of the Copper Scroll" (1992)                        |
| <i>NCE</i>                             | <i>New Catholic Encyclopedia</i>                                           |
| "Notes"                                | Wolters: "Notes on the Copper Scroll (3Q15)"                               |
| <i>NRSV</i>                            | New Revised Standard Version                                               |
| NS                                     | New Series                                                                 |
| <i>OY</i>                              | Eisenstein: <i>Ozar Yisrael</i>                                            |
| <i>PAPS</i>                            | <i>Proceedings of the American Philosophical Society</i>                   |
| <i>PEQ</i>                             | <i>Palestine Exploration Quarterly</i>                                     |
| Pixner                                 | "Unraveling the Copper Scroll Code"                                        |
| Pixner <sup>org</sup>                  | Pixner's original suggestion                                               |
| PsJ                                    | Targum Pseudo-Jonathan                                                     |
| QA                                     | Qumran Aramaic                                                             |
| <i>QCH</i>                             | <i>Qumran Chronicle</i>                                                    |
| <i>qeri</i> or קִי                     | קִי, how it is read in the Masoretic Text.                                 |
| QH                                     | Qumran Hebrew                                                              |

|                                                                             |                                                                    |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------|
| RB                                                                          | <i>Revue Biblique</i>                                              |
| RQ                                                                          | <i>Revue Qumran</i>                                                |
| SB                                                                          | Steinberg: <i>Millon haTenakh</i>                                  |
| SH                                                                          | Samaritan Hebrew                                                   |
| SH                                                                          | <i>Scripta Hierosolymitana</i>                                     |
| ST                                                                          | Samaritan Targum                                                   |
| STA                                                                         | Samaritan Targum, Nablus Congregation                              |
| STJ                                                                         | Samaritan Targum, British Museum Or 7562                           |
| Sum.                                                                        | Summary                                                            |
| SVT                                                                         | <i>Supplement to Vetus Testamentum</i>                             |
| SY                                                                          | Klein: <i>Sefer hayYišuv</i>                                       |
| t.                                                                          | Tosephta (followed by the Tractate)                                |
| TA                                                                          | Talmudic Aramaic                                                   |
| "The Copper Scroll of Qumran (3Q15) and the Greco-Roman Temple Inventories" | by Wilmot                                                          |
| "The Fifth Cache"                                                           | Wolters: "The Fifth Cache of the Copper Scroll"                    |
| "The Last Treasury"                                                         | Wolters: "The Last Treasury of the Copper Scroll"                  |
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| TJ                                                                          | Targum Jonathan on the Prophets                                    |
| TN                                                                          | Targum Neophyti                                                    |
| TO                                                                          | Targum Onkelos                                                     |
| Trg.                                                                        | Targum                                                             |
| TS                                                                          | Temple Scroll                                                      |
| UT                                                                          | Gordon: <i>Ugaritic Textbook</i>                                   |
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| Ba'al haṭTurim                               | by Rabbi Jacob ben Asher (c. 1268-1340)                                               |
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| Baraita' of the 32 Rules                     | by the Tanna Rabbi Eliazar ben Rabbi Yose hagGelili                                   |
| Be'er Reḥovot                                | by R. Isaac Eisik ben Isaiah Auerbach-Reis (18th cent.)                               |
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| Bekhor Shor                                  | Rabbi Joseph ben Isaac (12th cent.)                                                   |
| Bertinoro = Ra'av                            | Rabbi Obadiah ben Abraham Yare' (1445-1515)                                           |
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| Ga'on of Vilna = Gera'                       | Rabbi Eliah ben Solomon Zalman (1720-1797)                                            |
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- Hai Ga'on  
*HakKetav*  
*wehaqQabbalah*  
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Ibn-Saruq  
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*Keli Yaqar*  
  
Koren  
*Leḥem weSimlah*  
"LeŠiṭat hanNiqud  
šel hamMišnah"  
*Lešon Ḥayyim*  
*Ma'amar Yom-Tov*  
*Ma'arakhah Liqra't*  
*Ma'arakhah*  
Maimonides = Rambam  
Malbim  
Maharaz  
*Mahzor Vitry*  
*Mar'eh hapPanim*  
and *Penei Moshe*  
*Mattenot Kehunah*  
*Megillat Ta'anith*  
Me'iri or hamMe'iri  
*Mekhilta' deRabbi*  
*Šim'on bar Yoḥai*  
*Mekhilta' deRabbi*  
*Yišma'e'l*  
*Mele'khet Šelomoh*  
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probably the first Mishnaic-type collection  
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collection of Midrashim  
  
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by Rabbi Solomon ben Joshua 'Adeni (1567-1625?)  
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|                                                 |                                                                         |
|-------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <i>Mešudat David</i><br>and <i>Mešudat Zion</i> | by Rabbi David and his son Rabbi Jehiel Hillel Alt-schuler (18th cent.) |
| Meyuḥas, Rabbeinu                               | ben Eliah (c. 14th cent.)                                               |
| Midrash, Midrashim (pl.)                        | homily and biblical exegesis                                            |
| <i>Midrash Rabbah</i>                           | collection of Midrashim                                                 |
| <i>Midrash Ḥaḡeš</i>                            | collection of Midrashim (manuscript)                                    |
| <i>Mikhlol</i>                                  | by Radak                                                                |
| <i>Minḥat Šay</i>                               | by Rabbi Jedidiah Solomon Raphael ben Abraham Norzi (1560-1616)         |
| <i>Miqra'ot Gedolot</i>                         | Rabbinic Bibles with various commentaries                               |
| Mishnah, Mishnayot (pl.)                        | Tannaic teachings compiled by Rabbi Judah the Prince (2nd-3rd cent.)    |
| <i>Mišnah' Aḥaronah</i>                         | by R. Ephraim Isaac ben Loeb of Premislaw (1762-1842)                   |
| <i>Mišnah Berurah</i>                           | by Rabbi Israel Meir ben Aryeh Ze'ev hakKohen of Radin (1838-1933)      |
| <i>Mišnat Ya'aqov</i>                           | by Rabbi Jacob Saul haLevi Weinfeld (1981/82)                           |
| <i>Mišneh Torah</i>                             | by Maimonides (1135-1204)                                               |
| Mizraḥi = Re'em                                 | Rabbi Eliah b. Abraham of Constantinople (1448-1526)                    |
| <i>Musaf he'Arukh</i>                           | by Rabbi Benjamin b. Immanuel Mussafia (1606-1675)                      |
| Nahmanides = Ramban                             | Rabbi Moses ben Nahman (1194-1270)                                      |
| <i>Nehor Šeraga'</i>                            | by Rabbi Ephraim Judah b. Šeraga' Wiesenberg (1959)                     |
| Nissim Ga'on                                    | ben Jacob ibn Shahin (c. 990-1062)                                      |
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| <i>Patšegen hakKetav</i>                        | by R. Mordecai Mortara/Ventura/Vintora (16th cent. ?)                   |
| <i>Pentateuch</i>                               | by Rabbi Samson ben Raphael Hirsch (1808-1888)                          |
| Peruš Jonathan                                  | commentary on Targum Pseudo-Johnatan                                    |
| <i>Pesiqta' deRav Kahana'</i>                   | collection of Midrashim                                                 |
| Peter, Rabbeinu                                 | ben Joseph, Tosaphist                                                   |
| <i>Qorban ha'Edah</i>                           | by R. David ben Naphtali Hirsch Fränkel (1704-1762)                     |
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| Radak                                           | R. David ben Joseph Kimḥi Maistre Petit (1157-1236)                     |
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| Ran                                             | Rabbeinu Nissim ben Reuben Gerondi (14th cent.)                         |
| Rash                                            | Rabeinu Samson ben Abraham of Sens (d. 1220)                            |
| Rashbam                                         | Rabbi Samuel ben Meir (c. 1080-1140)                                    |
| Rashi                                           | Rabbi Solomon ben Isaac (1040-1105)                                     |
| Rema                                            | Rabbi Moses ben Israel Isserles (1530?-1572)                            |
| Ribeban = Judah Ya'aleh                         | Rabbi Judah ben Biniamin haRofo' 'Anaw (13th cent.)                     |
| Rid or Rit                                      | Rabbi Isaiah ben Mali di Trani the Elder (13th cent.)                   |
| Rieder, Rabbi David                             | <i>Targum Yonatan ben Uziel 'al haTorah, Meturgam le'Ivrit</i> (1984)   |

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| Rik                             | Rabbi Joseph ben Simeon Kara (11th cent.)                                                           |
| Rikam                           | Rabbi Joseph Kimhi Maistre Petit (12th cent.)                                                       |
| Rosh                            | Rabbi Asher ben Jehiel (1250-1327)                                                                  |
| Sa'adiah Ga'on = Rasag          | ben Joseph el-Fayumi (882-942)                                                                      |
| <i>Sefer ha'Agron</i>           | by Sa'adiah Ga'on                                                                                   |
| <i>Sefer habBaḥur</i>           | by Rabbi Eliah Levita-Baḥur ben Asher halLevi (1468/69-1549)                                        |
| <i>Sefer hamMa'arikh</i>        | by Rabbi Menahem b. Judah de Lonzano (1550- 1624?)                                                  |
| <i>Sefer hašŠorašim</i>         | by Ibn-Janah                                                                                        |
| <i>Sefer hašŠorašim</i>         | by Radak                                                                                            |
| <i>Sefer Šemot Meforaš</i>      | by Amos Hakham (1991)                                                                               |
| <i>Sefer Zikkaron</i>           | by Rikam                                                                                            |
| <i>Šeror Hammor</i>             | by Rabbi Jacob ben Jacob Moses Lissau (d. 1832).                                                    |
| Sforno                          | Rabbi Obadiah ben Jacob (c. 1340-1550)                                                              |
| <i>Siddur 'Ošar hatTefillot</i> | the classical prayerbook with commentaries (1915)                                                   |
| Sifra                           | collection of Midrashim                                                                             |
| Sifri                           | collection of Midrashim                                                                             |
| <i>Siftei Haḥkhamim</i>         | by Rabbi Shabbatai ben Joseph Streimer Meshorer Bass (1641-1718)                                    |
| Simon (ben) Keifa'              | Rabbi, Payṭan (9th cent. ?)                                                                         |
| "Šiyyunim weHe'arot"            | on the <i>Commentary on the Book of Job by Rabbeynu Meyuchos</i> by R. Ḥayyim Dov-Ber Chavel (1969) |
| Solomon bar Judah               | the Babylonian, Rabbi, Payṭan (10th cent.)                                                          |
| Soncino                         | Bible and Talmud translations                                                                       |
| Steinsaltz, Rabbi Adin          | <i>The Babylonian Talmud</i> with Heb. translation (1970-)                                          |
| <i>Šulḥan 'Arukh</i>            | the Codex of Halakhah                                                                               |
| <i>Tanach</i>                   | ed. by Rabbi Nosson Scherman (1996)                                                                 |
| <i>Tanḥuma'</i>                 | collection of Midrashim                                                                             |
| Targum, Targumim (pl.)          | various Aramaic renderings of Scriptures                                                            |
| <i>The Living Torah</i>         | by Rabbi Aryeh Kaplan (1934-1983)                                                                   |
| <i>Tif'eret Israel</i>          | by Rabbi Israel ben Gedaliah Lipschütz (1782-1860)                                                  |
| <i>Torah Shelemah</i>           | by Rabbi Menahem Mendel ben Issac Perez Kasher (1895-1983)                                          |
| <i>Torah Temimah</i>            | by R. Barukh b. Jehiel M. halLevi Epstein (1860-1942)                                               |
| <i>Tosaphot</i>                 | Talmud commentary by the Tosaphists                                                                 |
| <i>Tosephot Rabbeinu Isaac</i>  | ben Samuel the Elder of Dampierre (12th cent.)                                                      |
| <i>Tosephot Yom-Tov</i>         | by Rabbi Yom-Tov Lipman ben Nathan halLevi Heller (1579-1654)                                       |
| <i>Tosephta</i>                 | collection of baraita's                                                                             |
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| Wosner, Rabbi Samuel            | <i>Še'elot uTešuvot Ševet halLevi</i> (1982/3)                                                      |
| <i>Yalqut Šim'oni</i>           | Midrash collection by R. Simeon Frankfurt (c. 13th cent.)                                           |
| Zobel-Dimitrovsky               | <i>Bava' Meši'a'</i> with Heb. translation (1960)                                                   |
| <i>Zohar</i>                    | the major Kabbalistic work                                                                          |

Note: For many of these sources, see Bibliography for additional details.

## INTRODUCTION

### THE OFFICIAL RELEASE

An electrifying article entitled, "Dead Sea Scrolls Tell of Treasure — Key to Vast Riches Written on Copper Is Deciphered," appeared near the top of the front page of *The New York Times* on June 1, 1956. It was accompanied by a photograph of two copper rolls *in situ* and a map of the Holy Land identifying sites of the *buried treasures*. The report released in Amman, the capital of the Hashemite Kingdom of Jordan, included three excerpts translated from Hebrew into English by Father Józef Tadeusz Milik. The article claimed that:

The documents tell of hoards of fabulous value. If the treasure exists, it includes 200 tons of gold and silver.

An estimated value of such a treasure was given, but it was noted "the scholars doubt the reality of the treasure" mentioned in the rolls.<sup>1</sup>

The following day *The New York Times* printed a dispatch from Amman, entitled "Dead Sea 'Treasure' Doubted by Experts." In it, Prof. Gerold Lankester Harding, Director of the Jordan Antiquities Department, said:

he would be 'very surprised' if any of the 200 tons of buried gold and silver mentioned in the Dead Sea scrolls would be found now ... The scrolls suggested that the total amount of treasure in the area was about 200 tons which is a fantastic figure. It seems more likely that the scrolls record purely a collection of traditions.<sup>2</sup>

### DISCOVERY OF THE COPPER ROLLS

In 1952 a Bedouin discovered some additional manuscripts in the caves of Qumran in the Judean Desert. Consequently, at the suggestion of Harding, the Qumran Cave Expedition was organized by Père Roland de Vaux, Director of the École Biblique et Archéologique Française, Jerusalem, and Prof. William L. Reed, Annual Director of the American Schools of Oriental Research, Jerusalem. The expedition included representatives of the École Biblique, the American Schools of Oriental Research, and the Palestine Archaeological Museum (sponsored by the Rockefeller Foundation). The survey

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1 Page 1, cols. 2-4, and p. 21, cols. 2-3, written by S. Roland, Jr. A simultaneous news release appeared in the *Manchester Guardian*, and in other papers. "The authorized statement released on 1 June" was published at the end of the article by H. Wright Baker, "Notes on the Opening of the 'Bronze' Scrolls from Qumran," *BJRL* 39 (1956-57), 56.

2 June 2, 1956, p. 21, col. 4. The report is dated June 1, 1956. A subsequent article ap-

was conducted between March 10 and 22. It was on March 20th, that the team, lead by Henry de Contenson of the École Biblique, uncovered two brittle *bronze* rolls in Cave 3, about 2 km north of Khirbet Qumran.

The two rolls were appropriated by the Jordanian government and placed for safe keeping in the Palestine Archaeological Museum in Jerusalem.<sup>3</sup> Subsequently, chemical tests demonstrated that the composition of the original material of the rolls was almost pure copper. After opening the rolls they were recognized as two parts of the same document. Thus, the *bronze rolls* were officially named the *Copper Scroll — 3Q15*.<sup>4</sup>

### INITIAL DISCOVERY REPORTS

The first report of the discovery of the two copper rolls appeared in *The New York Times* on April 1, 1952, entitled, "Ancient Scrolls Found — Copper Sheets Left by Essenes Are Dug Up in Judea." It stated, in part, that:

Two twin copper sheets, rolled scrollwise, and apparently containing statues and laws of the Essenes, have been unearthed in a cave in Judea by Father Roland de Vaux, director of the Dominican Archaeological School.

Coins dating from the second Jewish revolt of 135 A.D. were discovered with the copper scrolls. The Essenes were a sect of pre-Christian Jews who lived an ascetic life, and were distinguished by such characteristics as community of property, the practice of charity and the pursuit of virtue. They date from about the Maccabean Age.

The discovery of the copper scrolls is believed unique. Inasmuch as it is the first time that metal scrolls have been unearthed in this area.<sup>5</sup>

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peared by Milik, "The Copper Document from Cave III, Qumran," *BA* 19 (1956), 60-64.

3 W.L. Reed, "The Qumran Caves Expedition of March, 1952," *BASOR* 135 (1954), 8-13. Reed lists the names of the participants as Père R. de Vaux and W. L. Reed (ASOR) co-directors; Père Dominic Barthélmy, Father J.T. Milik, Henry de Contenson of École Biblique, Azmi Khalil and Ibrahim Assula of the Palestine Archaeological Museum. Hasan Awad Qutshan of Amman was the foreman of the support group of 24 Beduins from the Ta'amre tribe. See also, R. de Vaux, "Exploration de la Région de Qumran, Rapport Préliminaire," *RB* 60 (1953), 555, 557; "Préface" and "Introduction," *DJD III*, 200-02; J.T. Milik, "The Copper Document from Cave III, Qumran," *BA* 19 (1956), 60-64; M. Baignet and R. Leigh, *The Dead Sea Scrolls Deception* (1991), 20-21; where the survey is considered "amateurish"; H. Shanks, "Is Vatican Suppressing the Dead Sea Scrolls?" *Understanding the Dead Sea Scrolls* (1992), 275-90, 310-11.

4 The siglum, *Copper Scroll — 3Q15*, is based on the following: *Copper* — the unique material of the roll; *Scroll* — the two rolls were originally one document; *3* — Cave III where the rolls were discovered; *Q* — Qumran, the location of the caves; *15* — the 15th manuscript or fragment discovered in that cave. The manuscripts found in Cave III are: (1) Hebrew biblical texts (3Q1-3Q3); (2) non-biblical Hebrew texts (3Q4-3Q9); (3) non-biblical Aramaic texts (3Q10-3Q14); (4) the Copper Scroll; all were published in *DJD III* (see F. Garcia Martinez, "Lista de MSS procedentes de Qumran," *Henoch* 11 [1989], 163-65).

5 Page 13, c. 6; as reported by Religious News Service from Jerusalem, Jordan, March 31, 1952.

A second report, "Scrolls of Bronze in Dead Sea Cave — 2 Tightly Rolled Sheets With Hebrew Text Found — May Be Old Testament Documents," appeared in the *The New York Times* on April 12, 1952. The report noted that:

A pair of tightly rolled bronze sheets with a lengthy text engraved in square Hebrew letters has been found in a cave near the Dead Sea, according to word received here today by Prof. A. Henry Detweiler of Cornell University, chairman of the Jerusalem School Committee of the American Schools of Oriental Research. The scrolls are now in Jerusalem in the possession of Père Roland de Vaux and Dr. William L. Reed, director of a French, American and Palestinian expedition to the Dead Sea Caves.

The indications are that the sheets may be important Old Testament documents, Professor Detweiler said. In the same region in 1947 were found parchment scrolls with Hebrew text of the Book of Isaiah and other Biblical manuscripts.

The earlier scrolls were of leather. Because the new sheets are of bronze, Professor Detweiler suggested that they might contain material regarded by the ancients as of the greatest importance.

Only a fragment of the text on the tightly rolled metal sheets is visible, according to the report received by Professor Detweiler. Until some technique to unroll the delicate scrolls without shattering them is devised it is impossible to do more than speculate about the find, he said.

However, other scholars have described the discovery as a "most sensational find." Prof. Millar Burrows, Winkley Professor of Biblical Theology at Yale University, said it was "surprising, quite new and totally unexpected."

The latest Dead Sea expedition was carried out in March by archaeologists of the international party in Jerusalem. The expedition has located and searched about forty caves similar to the one in which the 1947 finds were made.<sup>6</sup>

About a half year after the discovery of the bronze rolls, the following note appeared in the *Palestine Exploration Quarterly* from Harding "with the permission of his collaborator, Père De Vaux.

These were found by a joint expedition of the École Biblique et Archéologique Française, the American School of Oriental Research, and the Palestine Archaeological Museum. There are two pieces, one about 80 cms. the other 160 cms. long, by about 30 cms. in height. They are inscribed in columns, like a scroll, in what appears to be Aramaic, although it is not possible to read anything as yet. The longer roll consists of two pieces joined together by rivets, and the shorter piece was originally joined to the longer. It seems that they originally constituted a panel which was perhaps set up in a building, and during a time of danger they were removed, rolled up for convenience, and hidden

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<sup>6</sup> Page 13, col. 7; reported as "Special to The New York Times" from Itchaca, N.Y., April 11, 1952.

in the cave where they were found. They most probably date from the 1st century A.D. The problem of unrolling these remarkable objects is now being studied; the bronze is completely oxidised and is very brittle.<sup>7</sup>

Circa a year after the discovery, another article appeared in *The New York Times* mentioning the copper rolls.

Following the Israeli-Arab war, the Jordanian Department of Antiquities, the French Biblical and Archaeological School, the Palestine Archaeological Museum, and later, the American School of Oriental Research joined in expeditions in the area. Their most important find was two rolled-up sheets of bronze on which a long text in either Hebrew or Aramaic had been hammered.

Experiments still are being made to determine whether it will be possible to unroll these scrolls, the metal of which has oxidized completely, or whether it will be necessary to cut them into strips to read the text.<sup>8</sup>

In another article De Vaux discussed the Copper Scroll in *Revue Biblique* and included two photographs of the rolls.<sup>9</sup>

### THE UNOPENED ROLLS

In the spring of 1953, Karl George Kuhn (Göttingen University) studied the copper rolls while they were in a sealed showcase at the Palestine Archaeological Museum in Jerusalem. From the extruded letters and with help of mirrors and photographs, Kuhn deciphered some 220 letters making up over 50 words, and five sets of numerals. He also indicated circa three dozen places where he saw, but could not recognize the letters, 15 cases where the line starts or ends, and partially reconstructed some five words. In all, Kuhn was correct at least 90 percent of the cases. These included seven times the phrase, "dig (or hidden at) X cubits," and the word "gold."

Kuhn realized the typological relationship of the scrolls' script to the funerary tablet of King Uzziah of Judea (c. 50 CE), and of the numerical symbols to those used in the Elephantine Papyri of Egypt (sixth-fifth cent. BCE). He estimated that the two rolls have 10-12 columns, each 20-25 cm wide and

7 "The Palestine Exploration Fund — Notes and News," *PEQ* 84 (1952), 59. This is the first 'official' reference to the discovery of the copper rolls. De Vaux also reported the discovery of the bronze rolls ("Fouille au Khirbet Qumran, Rapport Préliminaire," *RB* 60 [1953], 84-85 [signed: September 30, 1952]).

8 "70 Ancient Scrolls Found at Dead Sea — Manuscripts in Cave Identified as Books of Old Testaments and History of Essenes — Discovered by Shepherds — Documents Will Keep Biblical Scholars Busy for at Least Generation, Says Expert." It was reported by "Religious News Service" from Jerusalem, Jordan, April 1, 1953, and appeared on April 2, 1953, on p. 29, col. 1.

9 "Exploration de la Région de Qumran, Rapport Préliminaire," *RB* 60 (1953), 555, 557-58, XXII-XXIVa (signed: Jerusalem, July 15, 1953).

having 16-17 lines, each line having 20-25 letters, resulting in a total of 3000-4000 letters.

Kuhn came to the conclusion that: (1) The content of the copper rolls is a Hebrew text influenced by Aramaic orthography. (2) It is neither a Biblical text, nor does it have religious content. (3) The rolls were not wall panels (as de Vaux earlier had suggested). And (4) it contains a list of the hidden treasures of the Essenes (since the rolls were discovered at Qumran).

In a memorandum to the Palestine Archaeological Museum in 1954, Kuhn recommended covering the rolls with a protective plastic shield and cutting them into longitudinal strips. Kuhn's advice and many of his assumptions and readings eventually were proven to be correct.<sup>10</sup>

### OPENING THE ROLLS

In 1955, on the advice of John Marco Allegro, lecturer, University of Manchester, England, a member of the International Committee on the Dead Sea Scrolls,<sup>11</sup> Harding secured permission from the Jordanian government to take the bronze rolls for cutting to the College of Science and Technology, the University of Manchester, England. By mid-January 1956, H. Wright Baker of the Department of Mechanical Engineering had finished the delicate task of cutting of both rolls. Allegro, the only Dead Sea Scroll scholar present, photographed the process, made preliminary readings, transcriptions, translation, and notes which he forwarded to Harding in Amman. However, Milik, a member of the Qumran Caves Expedition, was delegated the task of publishing of the Copper Scroll.<sup>12</sup> The twenty-three cut segments of the Copper

10 R. de Vaux, "Exploration de la region de Qumran," *RB* 60 (1953), 558; "Introduction" in *DJD* III, 201-02; K.G. Kuhn, "Les rouleaux de cuivre de Qumran," *RB* 61 (1954), 193-205; "Die Kupferrollen von Qumran und ihr Inhalt (Résumé)," *THLZ* 74 (1954), 303-04; "Der gegenwärtige Stand der Erforschung der in Palästina neu gefundenen hebräischen Handschriften," *THLZ* 81 (1956), 541-46. Y. Yadin, *The Message of the Scrolls* (1957), 156-57; *HamMegillot hagGenuzot mimMidbar Yehudah* (1957), 176-77; Allegro, 22; Allegro<sup>rev</sup>, 15-16; Lurie, 1-2. For a detailed discussion of Kuhn's readings, see "K.G. Kuhn and the Unopened Rolls" in Lefkovits<sup>diss</sup> 2, 1190-1204.

11 See E. Wilson, *The Dead Sea Scrolls — 1947-1969* (1969), 162-69; S.E. Hyman, "The Dead Sea Scrolls ... A Layman's View," *Commentary* 23 (1957), 571.

12 Allegro, 22-31; Allegro<sup>rev</sup>, 1-20, 29; J.T. Milik: "The Copper Document from Cave III, Qumran," *BA* 19 (1956), 62; H.W. Baker, "Notes on the Opening of the 'Bronze' Scrolls from Qumran," *BJRL* 39 (1956-57), 45-55; "Notes on the Opening of the Copper Scroll from Qumran," *DJD* III, 203-10; Milik, 137; A. Dupont-Sommer, *The Essene Writings from Qumran*, 379-81; R. de Vaux, "Manuscrits de Qumran," *RB* 68 (1961), 146-47; Lurie, 2; S. Glassman, *Megiles Fun Yam Hamelach* (1965), 44-45; I. Noble, *Treasure of the Caves* (1971), 184-195; Pixner, 330; A. Wolters, "Apocalyptic and the Copper Scroll," *JNES* 49 (1990), 146. Relatively few scholars mention Allegro's role in the opening of the Copper Scroll. Perhaps this is rectified by the publication of *The Allegro Qumran Collection* (1996; ed. G.J. Brooke), and by the *International Symposium on the Copper Scroll* at the

Scroll were sent back to Jordan in April, 1956. They were on display in the Archaeological Museum of Amman till 1993.<sup>13</sup>

The opening of the smaller roll was reported in *The New York Times* on January 13, 1956. The article was entitled, "Britons 'Solving' Dead Sea Scroll — Manchester University Team Succeeds in Unrolling One of the Oxydized Copper — Translation has Begun — 2,000-Year-Old Cave Find Is Said to Have Defeated Efforts of U.S. Experts." It stated that:

A scholar-scientist here has succeeded in the delicate task of unrolling one of the famous Dead Sea Scrolls. Professor H. Wright Baker of Manchester University, helped by a small team of assistants, has pried open the 2,000-year-old copper scroll and translation of it has begun ...

The scroll in Professor Wright's hand reached him completely oxydized. His problem was to unroll it without obliterating the writing.

One of his assistants, John Allegro, lecturer in philology at the university, said tonight the scroll previously had been in the care of American experts who tried unsuccessfully for three years to find a method of unrolling it. Professor Baker's method of getting at the text was not disclosed, but it was learned that translation has begun ...

It is understood the scroll, one foot wide and eight feet long, is not a biblical text, but it may be the key to the location of further manuscripts or a text on the teachings, beliefs and civic regulations of the people living in the area...

The scroll went to the United States three years ago, Mr. Allegro said, but it remained the property of the Jordanian Government. It came to Manchester University because this was the only British institution to subscribe toward the cost of finding and deciphering the document.

Each night, the scroll is locked in a safe and only four men are sharing the discoveries already made. Mr. Allegro, one of the four, said "the secrets will probably be released in the summer, simultaneously in London, Washington and in Jordan" ...

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University of Manchester, September 8-11, 1996 (organized by G.J. Brooke). See also, G.J. Brooke, "The Manchester Symposium on the Copper Scroll," *QCH* 6 (1996), 1-2; Z.J. Kaper, "International Symposium on the Copper Scroll in Manchester," *QCH* 6 (1996), 3-8.

13 J.T. Milik, "The Copper Document from Cave III, Qumran," 61. It was claimed that King Hussein ordered the removal of the Copper Scroll from Jerusalem to Amman at the start of Six Day War; and that the Copper Scroll is the only Dead Sea Scroll in the possession of the Jordanians (cf. L.H. Schiffman, "Jordanian Stamps Picturing the Dead Sea and the Qumran Scrolls," *Judaica Philatelic Journal* 2 [1975], 1490; G. Vermes, *The Dead Sea Scrolls, Qumran in Perspective* [1977], 23). Both of these turned out to be unfounded. According to S.A. Reed, "collections include ... the Copper Scroll and 15 other plates (11 plates from Cave 1, four plates from Cave 4) now located in the Archaeological Museum in Amman, Jordan" ("Survey of the Dead Sea Scrolls Fragments and Photographs at the Rockefeller Museum," *BA* 54 [1991], 48). A photograph depicts a display in 1966 in the Archaeological Museum in Amman that includes the sections of the Copper Scroll, manuscript fragments mostly from Cave 1, two storage jars used for scrolls, and two inkwells.

Dr. Harry M. Orlinsky, Professor of Bible at Hebrew Union College — Jewish Institution of Religion, an authority on the Dead Sea scrolls, expressed the opinion that the prying open at Manchester University of the 2,000-year-old copper find “was the first successful attempt.”

Dr. Orlinsky confirmed that previous attempts had been made and had been unsuccessful.

“If the report is true that names and places are recorded in these scrolls,” he said, “then they can very well be of very great importance for Biblical historians” ...<sup>14</sup>

Six weeks later another report, entitled “Two Bronze Scrolls Read Line by Line,” appeared in *The New York Times*. It reported that:

Technologists at the University of Manchester have disclosed how they opened the two bronze scrolls from the collection of religious writings found in caves near the Dead Sea. But they will not yet say what was inscribed on the metal about 2,000 years ago. Both scrolls were said to be completely oxidized and none of the original metal was left.

The scrolls, the property of the Jordan Government, were lent to the University by G. Lankester Harding, director of the Jordan Department of Antiquities. They have now been deciphered, but the Jordan Government has not granted permission for publishing the text.

Prof. Wright Baker of the Mechanical Engineering Department, had the scrolls cut into strips and photographed the writings line by line as it emerged. More than 300 photographs were taken, and Professor Baker said he believed not a letter had been lost. The Dissection work was begun by putting a spindle through the scrolls, spraying them with aircraft glue and baking them hard so they could be handled safely. The cutting was done with a small circular saw such as is used for splitting pen nibs.<sup>15</sup>

Finally, on June 25, 1974, the Hashemite Kingdom of Jordan issued a series of stamps depicting the Dead Sea Scrolls. Two stamps have the photograph of the Copper Scroll *in situ*.<sup>16</sup> This implies the degree of significance given to this historic document.

## MAJOR PUBLICATIONS ON THE COPPER SCROLL

The text and/or translation of the Copper Scroll has been published by Milik, Allegro, Lurie, Rodrigues,<sup>17</sup> Tocci, Moraldi,<sup>18</sup> Pixner, Wolters, Lefkovits

14 Page 28, col. 8; as reported by Reuters from Manchester, England, January 12, 1953.

15 February 26, 1956, p. 43, col. 3; as a special report to *The New York Times* from London, February 25, 1956.

16 L.H. Schiffman, “Jordanian Stamps Picturing the Dead Sea and the Qumran Scrolls,” *Judaica Philatelic Journal* 2 (1975), 1488-90.

17 M.A. Rodrigues, “Aspectos linguisticos do documento de cobre de Qumran (3Q15),” *Biblos. Revista da Faculdade de Letras, Universidade de Coimbra* 39 (1963), 329-423; includes a Portuguese translation.

18 F.M. Tocci, *I manoscritti del Mar Morto* (1967), 361-67, and L. Moraldi, *I manos-*

(doctoral dissertation), Muchowski (doctoral dissertation), Garcia Martinez, Beyer, Vermes, and Wise.

The varying interpretations of the text have resulted from such problems as: (1) Identifying similarly shaped characters. (2) Grouping characters into words. (3) Recognizing unique words. (4) Arranging words into phrases and sentences. (5) Organizing sentences into paragraphs or items. And (6) translating the original Hebrew into a modern language. In addition, religious bias, scholarly background, professional rivalry, and politics undoubtedly have influenced the nature of the approach to the study of the Copper Scroll.

Milik of the *École Biblique et Archéologique Française*, who later joined the National Center for Scientific Research in Paris, is a former Jesuit priest and a distinguished Dead Sea Scroll scholar. Milik published French and English translations with commentaries on the Copper Scroll in 1959 and in 1960 respectively.<sup>19</sup> His official *editio princeps* appeared in 1962. It includes a Hebrew transcription and a French translation of the text, commentary, glossary, drawings parallel to composite photographs of the rolls, etc.<sup>20</sup>

Milik's articles, and the official news release and publications, strongly suggest that he had a preconceived notion that the content of the Scroll is a "fairy-tale created by a crank." This idea, his rivalry with Allegro, the desire of some scholars and the Jordanian government to avoid a *gold rush* in the Jordan Valley, may well have influenced Milik's interpretations of the Scroll.

Allegro had been preparing for the Methodist ministry, but turned toward Semitic studies. He was instrumental in securing the release of the rolls from Jordan to be taken to Manchester for opening. Allegro was the only Dead Sea Scroll scholar present during its opening, which proceeded under his supervision.<sup>21</sup> He photographed the process, made preliminary readings, transcriptions, a translation, and notes which he sent back to Harding in Jordan.

The author was fortunate to receive from Allegro's widow, Mrs. Joan R. Allegro, a copy of her husband's first translation and notes. It proved most instructive to see the challenge Allegro faced, his train of thought, and perceptive insight from the provisional through his two editions of the Copper Scroll. This manuscript is identified by the author as "Allegro's Provisional

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*critti di Qumrān* (1971), 717-22; both include an Italian translation.

19 "Le rouleau de cuivre de Qumran (3Q15). Traduction et commentaire topographique," *RB* 66 (1959), 321-57 (= Milik<sup>F</sup>); "The Copper Document from Cave III of Qumran, Translation and Commentary," *Annual of the Department of Antiquities of Jordan* 4-5 (1960), 137-55 (= Milik<sup>E</sup>). See also Allegro<sup>rev</sup>, 37.

20 "Le rouleau de cuivre provenant de la grotte 3Q (3Q15)," *DJD III*, 211-17, 221-302, 314-17, xlv-lxxii (= Milik).

21 J.M. Allegro, *The Dead Sea Scrolls and the Christian Myth* (1979), 27. According to Brooke, due to the conflict with the 'scroll authorities,' Allegro was not permitted to be present at the opening of the second roll. He saw the cut segments only after the work was completed (personal communication).

Translation and Notes on the Copper Scroll,” and it is published for the first time in this book.<sup>22</sup>

In 1960 Allegro published drawings of the inscription, transliteration, English translation, footnotes, commentary, discussions, plans, and photographs of the Copper Scroll.<sup>23</sup> In his studies, Allegro utilized Milik’s French translation which appeared in 1959.<sup>24</sup>

Allegro’s second edition of the Copper Scroll was published in 1964. It contains a revised translation, but it has neither drawings, nor transliterations, nor footnotes.<sup>25</sup> Allegro in 29 cases, retracts his new translation in favor of Milik’s version.<sup>26</sup> Both works of Allegro were written in a popular style in contrast with Milik’s scholarly approach.

According to Allegro, the Copper Scroll is an authentic document describing the buried treasures of the Second Temple of Jerusalem. Allegro, seeking to arrive at a realistic figure, drastically reduces the value of the talent into mina, and then mina into shekel, a mere 1/50-1/60 of their actual weight.<sup>27</sup>

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22 This manuscript has two parts: (a) The smaller roll consisting of Columns 9-12 (indicated by Allegro as I-IV), made right after its opening. (A copy of this was sent to Harding in November 1956. In a letter dated December 1, 1956, Allegro sent to Harding several corrections to his original report.) (b) The larger roll consisting of Columns 1-8 (indicated as I-VIII), Allegro prepared after its opening in January 1957. The original English translation and notes were typewritten, with non-English words added by hand. This material is identified in this work as Allegro<sup>pr</sup> (i.e., Allegro’s provisional version). Since this was Allegro’s working copy, it contains many later handwritten corrections. These changes are noted as Allegro<sup>tr</sup> (i.e., Allegro’s revised provisional version). Although this is a logical division, it presents some problems. Several corrections on Columns 9-12 were made weeks before the second roll was opened, consequently, some Allegro<sup>tr</sup> material precede that of Allegro<sup>pr</sup>. Moreover, frequently in his notes spaces were left out for Hebrew words, but these were not added. In a few cases in the copy received the bottom lines are missing. Allegro was the first to decipher and translate the entire Scroll, which he sent back to Jordan, therefore, one can reasonable assume that Milik was aware of Allegro’s material and utilized it. For this reason, in the Commentary when the readings of the scholars are given, Allegro’s is presented first.

23 *The Treasure of the Copper Scroll: The Opening and Decipherment of the Most Mysterious of the Dead Sea Scrolls, A Unique Inventory of Buried Treasure* (= Allegro). David Noel Freedman read the manuscript and offered “constructive criticism and suggestions” (p. 8). His initials occur in two notes (165 n. 278a, and 170 n. 323). The copyright in the first edition reads, “Copyright 1960 by John Marco Allegro and David Noel Freedman”; while in the revised one, “Copyright 1960, 1964 by John Allegro, Ltd.”

24 Allegro<sup>rev</sup>, 37. This can be seen in some corrections in Allegro<sup>tr</sup>.

25 *The Treasury of the Copper Scroll* (1964; = Allegro<sup>rev</sup>).

26 These are in lines: 1:6, 1:9, 1:11, 2:5, 2:6, 2:9, 2:12, 2:13, 3:8, 3:11, 4:11, 4:14, 5:13 (2x), 7:1, 7:11 (2x), 7:14, 8:2, 9:6, 9:17, 10:3, 11:5 (2x), 11:16 (2x), 12:1, 12:4, and 12:13. Since some of these retractions can be found in Allegro’s preliminary reading, Milik’s suggestions might have motivated Allegro to return to his original renditions; e.g., Allegro<sup>pr</sup>: “the steps”; Allegro: המעלות, “the entrance”; Milik: המעלה, “the steps”; Allegro<sup>rev</sup>: “the ascent” (12:4).

27 Allegro, 60; 135-36 n. 8. See Appendix A.

He also suggests that the Greek letters in the Copper Scroll may "refer to the derivation of the sacred material hidden at these places."<sup>28</sup>

Allegro often mentions Milik and Baker respectfully, even their photographs appear in some of his books.<sup>29</sup> On the other hand, Baker totally disregards Allegro, while Milik mentions him only once, and in an unfavorable light. This clearly reflects the nature of the relationship between the two.<sup>30</sup>

Ben-Zion Lurie, an Israeli scholar of Bible, Talmudim, and Midrashim, is the founder-editor of the Hebrew quarterly *Beth Mikra*, and author of many historical and geographical works.<sup>31</sup> Lurie published his study on the Copper Scroll in 1964.<sup>32</sup> It contains an improved version of Allegro's drawing, transcription, a Modern Hebrew translation of the text, a commentary, and discussions. He relied on Allegro's first edition, and that by Milik. Lurie makes extensive use of Biblical, Targumic, and Talmudic sources.

Lurie equates the talent mentioned in the Scroll with the Roman libra, which is basically in agreement with Allegro's suggestion. Lurie accepts the theory that a Third Temple existed during the short reign of Bar-Kokhba (132-35 CE). The Scroll lists the wealth of that temple. In addition, the seven sets of Greek letters in the Scroll are codes representing seven parts of the temple's main budget.<sup>33</sup>

Bargil Virgil Pixner, OSB, is a Benedictine archaeologist in Jerusalem, a member of the Theological Faculty of the Dormition Abbey on Mount Zion,

28 Allegro, 136 n. 9. See Appendix C.

29 E.g., Allegro, 23 pl. 2; Allegro<sup>rev</sup>, pls. 4 and 11 following p. 66.

30 Milik, 299. This was noted by Greenfield (135b). Reportedly, Milik became enraged because Allegro broke an understanding by publishing his work before the official edition (M. Baignet and R. Leigh, *The Dead Sea Scrolls Deception* [1991], 47-66). Baignet and Leigh describe the survey in Qumran conducted by de Vaux and his colleagues between March 10 and 22, 1952, which discovered the Copper Scroll, and the opening of the rolls (pp. 20-21). They elaborate on Allegro's publication of the Copper Scroll (pp. 51-56), and barely mention Milik's official publication (p. 36). See also, H. Shanks, "Is Vatican Suppressing the Dead Sea Scrolls?" *Understanding the Dead Sea Scrolls* (1992), 275-90, 310-11; P.R. Davies, "The Qumran Affair: 1947-1993," *QCH*, 5 (1995), 137; "Notes en Marge: Reflections on the publication of DJDJ V," *QCH*, 5 (1995), 145; N.A. Silberman, *The Hidden Scrolls* (1994), 147-48.

31 See "Tribute to Ben Zion Lurie," *Dor le-Dor* 10 (1982), 141-43.

32 *Megillot hanNehošet mimMidbar Yehudah* (= Lurie).

33 Lurie, 6-7, 56-58 n. 8 ("Milik" instead of "Allegro" on p. 56, line 9, is a typographical error). Lurie republished with minor changes the chapter dealing with Bar-Kokhba's Temple, entitled "בית המקדש בימי בר-כוכבא" in his book *Pirquei Yerusālayim* (1980), 345-67. Concerning Bar-Kokhba's temple, see J. Kohen, "בר כוכבא" in *Jerusalem* 6 (1903), 306-17; J. Goldman, "הריסת הבית השלישי" in *Jerusalem* 7 (1907), 70-76; M. Auerbach, "הקרבנות קרבנות אחר חרבן הבית" in *Jeschurun — Hebrew Supplement* 4 (1923), 23-29. For further references, see M. Bar-Ilan, "The Process of Writing the Copper Scroll," note 4, *Internet*, <http://popeye.cc.biu.ac.il/barilm/coperite.html> (August 31, 1998). Regarding Bar-Kokhba, see #32, 7:14-15.

Jerusalem. He published a lengthy article entitled, "Unraveling the Copper Scroll Code — A Study of the Topography of 3Q15" in 1983.<sup>34</sup> The study contains an English translation, transliteration of a third of the Hebrew text, footnotes, description of the discovery, discussion of the controversy over the first official publication, authenticity of the document, topographical commentary, plans, and an excellent bibliography.<sup>35</sup>

Pixner relies heavily on Milik's edition, yet he considers the works of Allegro, Lurie, and most of the other published articles dealing with the Scroll till 1983. Unfortunately, Pixner does not mention Jonas C. Greenfield's highly critical review of Milik's work, wherein Greenfield raises serious questions regarding Milik's approach and many of his interpretations.<sup>36</sup>

Pixner refutes Milik's fairy-tale theory, and views the Scroll as a genuine document. The places mentioned in the Scroll are considered Essene colonies, and the hidden treasures belonged to them. Pixner divides the text into five topographical regions: the Essene Gate of Jerusalem, Jericho, Land of Damascus, Vicinity of Jerusalem, and Northern Palestine.

Pixner, who claims that Lurie "distorts the text quite violently occasionally to fit his Bar Kokhba theory,"<sup>37</sup> regrettably, falls himself into a similar trap. To fit into his theory of the existence of Essene settlements, Pixner manipulates sound readings, and separates phrases contrary to accepted Hebrew grammar and logic. He also arbitrarily reads into the text the name of Yeshu, the Hebrew form of Jesus, which raises serious question of bias on his part.<sup>38</sup>

Pixner proposes that the seven sets of Greek letters are the initial two-three letters of contemporary Greek personal names, and cites such names from the writings of Josephus.<sup>39</sup> Accordingly, these individuals might had been responsible for some of the deposits.<sup>40</sup> Pixner's suggestion is similar to Allegro's that the Greek letters "refer to the derivation of the sacred material," and to Lurie's that they represent symbols of certain funds.<sup>41</sup> The suggestions

34 *RQ* 11 (1983), 323-61, i-iv (= Pixner).

35 Pixner's other relevant studies are: "An Essene Quarter on Mount Zion?," *SH* 1 (1976), 245-84; "Sion III, 'Nea Sion' — Topographische und geschichtliche Untersuchung des Sitzes der Urkirche und seiner Bewohner," *Das heilige Land* 111 (1979), 3-13; "Das Essenquartier in Jerusalem und dessen Einfluss auf die Urkirche," *Das heilige Land* 113 (1981), 3-14; "Copper Scroll (3Q15)," *ABD* 1, 1133a-34a.

36 "The Small Caves of Qumran," *JAOS* 89 (1969), 128-41 (esp. 135-41; = Greenfield).

37 Pixner, 332.

38 Pixner, 344-46 n. 11. Pixner (345) attempts to read "the banished (cast-off) House of Jesus" and suggests that it might have been "the meeting place of the Judeo-Christians" or the followers of the Jesus-family (see #7, 2:3).

39 Josephus Flavius (c. 38 CE - c. 100 CE), author of *The Jewish War*, *Jewish Antiquities*, and *Against Apion*, lived during the period when the Copper Scroll is considered to have been engraved (c. 25-75 CE).

40 Pixner, 335 n. 32.

41 Lurie, 58.

by Allegro, Lurie, and Pixner are superior to those by Edward Ullendorff, who equates the Greek letters with numerical values.<sup>42</sup>

The late David J. Wilmot's doctoral dissertation, prepared under the supervision of Norman Golb (University of Chicago), is being edited by Michael Owen Wise, will be published sometimes in the future.<sup>43</sup>

Al Wolters (Redeemer College, Ancaster, Ontario) is working on a book dealing with the Copper Scroll. Wolters published a number of articles,<sup>44</sup> as well as a pamphlet, *The Copper Scroll: Overview, Text and Translation*.<sup>45</sup>

P. Kayle McCarter, Jr. (John Hopkins University), prepares a new edition of the Copper Scroll under the editorship of James H. Charlesworth. For this purpose the Zuckerman brothers were requested to photograph the Scroll in Amman. McCarter in several articles discusses such Scroll topics as, the discovery, opening, publications, deteriorated condition, Greek letters, language, spelling, *dema*<sup>c</sup> vessels. He also provides a translation of five items. McCarter links the House of Hakkoz with the priestly family Hakkoz, "the treasurers of the Temple." He concludes that the name Hakkoz, as well as many "technical religious terminology" mentioned in the text, suggest "that the Copper Scroll treasure was wealth somehow associated with the Temple of Jerusalem," rather than with the Qumran community.<sup>46</sup>

42 "The Greek Letters of the Copper Scroll," VT 11 (1961), 227-28. See Appendix C.

43 See "The Copper Scroll of Qumran (3Q15) and the Greco-Roman Temple Inventories," lecture hand-out by D.J. Wilmot at the combined annual meetings of the American Academy of Religion and the American Schools of Oriental Research, Chicago, December 1984; H. Shanks, "Annual Meetings Offer Intellectual Bazaar and Moments of High Drama," BAR 11 (1985), 14a-b; M.O. Wise, "The Copper Scroll," *Parabola*, 19 (1994), 44-52; "David J. Wilmot and the Copper Scroll," an article submitted to the *International Symposium on the Copper Scroll*, Manchester, 1996. Regarding the communication of this author and the late Wilmot, see Lefkovits<sup>diss</sup> 1, 84-86 n. 142.

44 "Notes on the Copper Scroll (3Q15)," RQ 12 (1987), 589-96 (= "Notes"); "The Last Treasure of the Copper Scroll," JBL 107 (1988), 419-29 (= "The Last Treasure"); "The Fifth Cache of the Copper Scroll: 'The Plastered Cistern of Manos'," RQ 13 (1988), 167-76 (= "The Fifth Cache"); "The Copper Scroll and the Vocabulary of Mishnaic Hebrew," RQ 14 (1990), 483-95 (= "Vocabulary"); "Apocalyptic and the Copper Scroll," JNES 49 (1990), 145-54; "History and the Copper Scroll," a hand-out of a lecture at the New York Academy of Sciences on December 16, 1992; "Literary Analysis and the Copper Scroll," *Intertestamental Essays in Honor of Józef Tadeusz Milik* 1 (1992), 239-52 (= "Analysis"); "History and the Copper Scroll," ANYAS 772 (1994), 285-98 (= "History"); "The Shekinah in the Copper Scroll: A New Reading of 3Q15 12.10," *The Scrolls and the Scriptures: Qumran Fifty Years After* (1997), 382-91; "The Copper Scroll," *The Dead Sea Scrolls After Fifty Years: A Comprehensive Assessment*, 1 (1998), 302-23.

45 Sheffield, 1996 (= Wolters).

46 "The Mysterious Copper Scroll, Clues to Hidden Temple Treasure?" BR 8 (1992), 34-41, 63-64a; "The Mystery of the Copper Scroll" in *Understanding the Dead Sea Scrolls*, 227-41, 309; "The Mystery of the Copper Scroll" in *The Dead Sea Scroll After Forty Years* (1992), 40-55; "The Copper Scroll Treasure as an Accumulation of Religious Offerings," ANYAS 772 (1994), 133-48 (= McCarter).

Florentino Garcia Martinez (University of Groningen) includes the Copper Scroll with an introduction in his book *The Dead Sea Scroll Translated — The Qumran Texts in English*.<sup>47</sup>

Klaus Beyer published his reading and German translation with notes in his work, *Die aramäischen Texte vom Toten Meer, Ergänzungsband*.<sup>48</sup>

Geza Vermes (University of Oxford) in his book, *The Dead Sea Scrolls in English*, included the Copper Scroll with an introduction.<sup>49</sup>

Michael Owen Wise (University of Chicago) translated the Copper Scroll with an introduction in *The Dead Sea Scrolls: A New Translation*.<sup>50</sup>

Piotr Muchowski (Adam Mikiewicz University, Poznan) wrote a doctoral dissertation on the Copper Scroll in Polish.<sup>51</sup> He also published several articles dealing with the Scroll.<sup>52</sup>

Vendyl M. Jones (Vendyl Jones Research Institutes, Arlington, Texas) considers the Copper Scroll as the most important document ever found. The Scroll may help to locate certain items from the Temple, such as the ashes of the red heifer. To find those, Jones conducted several excavations in Israel.<sup>53</sup>

An extensive literature has accumulated since the discovery of the Copper Scroll. These scholarly works fall into four categories: (1) Major (journal) articles.<sup>54</sup> (2) Review articles.<sup>55</sup> (3) Books about the Dead Sea Scrolls with information relative to the Copper Scroll.<sup>56</sup> (4) Encyclopedia articles.<sup>57</sup>

47 (1994), 461-63 (= Garcia Martinez). The Spanish title is, *Textos de Qumrán* (1992).

48 (1994), 224-33 (= Beyer).

49 Revised and extended fourth edition (1995), 372-78 (= Vermes).

50 With co-authors Martin G. Abegg, Jr., and Edward M. Cook (1996), 188-99 (= Wise). Apparently, Wise relies on Wilmot's dissertation mentioned above.

51 *Zwój Miedziany (3Q15). Implikacje spornych kwestii lingwistycznych* (Copper Scroll [3Q15]. Implications of the Controversial Linguistic Problems), International Institute of Ethnolinguistic and Oriental Studies, Steszew, Poznań (1993). See Z. Kapera, "Piotr Muchowski, 'Zwój Miedziany (3Q15) ...,'" *QCH* 4 (1994), 113; S. Segert, "The Copper Scroll (3Q15) — Its Structure and Its Role (Review Article)," *QCH* 6 (1996), 125-35.

52 "Dysorthographic forms *hāpōn* and 'akōn in 3Q15," *Intertestamental Essays in Honor of Józef Tadeusz Milik*, 131-33; "Language of the Copper Scroll in the Light of the Phrases Denoting the Directions of the World," *ANYAS* 772 (1994), 319-27; "Two Proposals of Reading in the Eight Column of 3Q15," *QCH* 4 (1994), 85; etc.

53 *Qumran Excavations, Cave of the Column Complex & Environs* (1995); see also, D.C. Browning, Jr., "The Strange Search for the Ashes of the Red Heifer," *BA* 59 (1996) 74-89.

54 E.g., by Bardtke, Dupont-Sommer, Bar-Ilan, Brooke, Bull, Bull and Wright, Broshi, Burchard, Charlesworth, Cross, Gevaryahu, Golb, Jeremias, Kapera, Kuhn, Laperrousaz, Lehmann, McCarter, Meyer, Molin, Morawiecki, Mowinkel, Muchowski, Noetscher, Puech, Sanders, Sarfati, Schick, Segert, Sharvit, Schiffman, Silberman, Qimron, Thorion, Wieand, Zeitlin.

55 E.g., by Brown, Bruce, Delcor, Delling, Driver, Fitzmyer, Franken, Fritsch, Greenfield, Habermann, Isenberg, Jongeling and van der Wonde, Licht, (E.) Margoliouth, Martin, Pelikan, Roberts, Stanislav, (D.W.) Thomas, Zahari.

56 E.g., by Baignet and Leigh, Betz and Riesner, Brownlee, Bruce, Coss, Cross, Driver, (A.P.) Davies, (P.R.) Davies, Dupont-Sommer, Fitzmyer, Fritsch, Gaster, Glassman, Haag,

## THE PRESENT STATE OF THE COPPER SCROLL

The deteriorating state of the Copper Scroll was first reported by McCarter.<sup>58</sup> This problem significantly increases the difficulty of ascertaining with accuracy many critical readings in the Scroll.

In 1993 the 23 segments of the Copper Scroll were taken to Electricité de France (EDF), Valectra Laboratory, Paris, for restoration. This included X-rays, digitalization and reconstruction by image processing, molding and electroformed facsimile (galvanoplasty) of the roll. With the aid of computers and X-rays, fragments were identified, glued together, imprints were made, etc.<sup>59</sup> Based on this work, Père Émile Puech (École Biblique et Archéologique Française, Jerusalem) is preparing a new drawing, reading, and commentary on the Copper Scroll.<sup>60</sup>

Since some edges, especially where the rolls were cut into segments, oxidized and disappeared with time, new drawings will have to rely on the existing ones, on the original photographs, and those taken later by the Zuckerman brothers. To do this, the restorer's intuition is important, however, this itself may introduce a new element of subjectivity. Therefore, in cases, for example, where Allegro's material indicate letters in toto or in part on the cut or crack, and those cannot be seen in Milik's, such issues will remain unresolved (see "The Drawings" in the Discussion). It seems that the deterioration process began as soon as the rolls were cut into 23 segments. This can be seen by comparing the drawings of Milik and Allegro. This may also explain some of the differences between these two drawings. Protective measures should have been taken immediately upon the segmentation of the rolls. Unfortunately this did not take place and consequently the understanding of the Scroll has suffered.<sup>61</sup>

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Harrison, Jeremias, Jongeling, Laperrousaz, Mansoor, van der Ploeg, (C.) Roth, Rowley, (L.H.) Silberman, (N.H.) Silberman, Tov, de Vaux, VanderKam, Vermes, Wacholder, (E.) Wilson, Yadin, Yizhar.

57 E.g., by Bruce, (C.) Cohen, Collins, Fitzmyer, Gaster, Kalai, Licht, Negev, Ryan, Safrir, Sarfati, (R.J.) Thomas, Vermes.

58 "The Mysterious Copper Scroll, Clues to Hidden Temple Treasure?" *BR* 8 (1992), 38; "The Mystery of the Copper Scroll" in *Understanding the Dead Sea Scrolls* (1992), 233.

59 "Le Rouleau de Cuivre de la Mer Morte," *La Cahiers Valectra* 3 (1996), 4-13 (EDF). Also, *Photos de la Restauration des Rouleaux de Qumran*, CD-ROM by EDF, 1996, which this writer received from EDF at the *International Symposium on the Copper Scroll* in Manchester.

60 See also, H. Shanks, *The Mystery and Meaning of the Dead Sea Scrolls* (1998), 195; E. Puech, "Quelques résultats d'un nouvel examen du Rouleau de Cuivre (3Q15)," *RQ* 18 (1997), 163-90.

61 The author suggested many years ago that X-ray radiographs should be taken from both sides of each segment of the Scroll, a technique which might have clarified some problematic readings. Such X-ray films can be taken in a continuous manner similar to the method used by radiologists when they X-ray the nasal sinuses that have irregular surfaces. (Years later, the X-ray approach was again proposed to Profs. Charlesworth and Zuckerman

## THE TEXT AND ITS PROBLEMS

The Copper Scroll has several unique characteristics, such as the material used, mode of inscription, language, and content. The text is hammered into three almost pure copper sheets, each about eighty centimeters long by thirty centimeters wide and one millimeter thick. The three sheets were originally riveted together. At the time of the discovery the larger roll consisted of the first two sheets while the smaller one being the third sheet.

The document has 12 columns, with each sheet having four columns. There are 181 lines, with each line having between 3-32 symbols. This adds up to about 3000 Hebrew characters or 713 words, 33 sets of numerals, and seven sets of two-three Greek letters.<sup>62</sup> The Greek letters, some of which may be Latin, are present only in the first sheet, and they are of cryptic nature (see Appendix C). The numerals are known from the Elephantine Papyri (sixth-fifth cent. BCE), Phoenician and Second Temple era Palestinian inscriptions, and other Dead Sea Scrolls (see Appendix B).

The scribes generated each symbol on the soft copper sheets, probably mounted on a smooth wood surface, by several hammer blows on a chisel-like tool, thus extruding the script on the back side. If the scribe used only one type of engraving tool, then he had to use perhaps up to ten hammer blows to create some of the characters. If he used tools of different shapes and sizes, it required fewer blows. Either way, engraving about 3000 signs was a very laborious and time consuming operation.

The size of an average character, except *waw*, *zayin*, *yod*, and final *nun*, is about one square centimeter. The script is late Herodian semiformal square. It is known from inscriptions, such as the Plaque of King Uzziah, of Queen Helena, of Beth She'arim, some Qumran documents. Based on paleographical evidence, Cross dates the Copper Scroll back to the years 25-75 CE.<sup>63</sup>

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[personal communication].) Also, that the segments should be photographed both front and reversed sides (like the method later used by the Zuckermans). In addition, the existing original photographs and negatives in Manchester and in the Rockefeller Museum in Jerusalem, including the photographs of the Zuckerman brothers, plus the proposed X-ray radiographs should be fed into a special computer program which would compare and enhance the photographs. Such a process would produce pictures that provide a better reading and understanding of the Scroll (see Lefkovits<sup>diss</sup> 1, 57-58). These suggestions were somewhat similar to those which EDF has undertaken.

62 Columns 1-2 have 15 lines each, Column 3 has 13 lines, Columns 4-6 have 14 lines each, Column 7-8 have 16 lines each, Columns 9-11 have 17 lines each, and Column 12 has 13 lines. The shortest line is 1:15, which according to the drawings of Baker and Milik, consists of two letters after a lacuna of one square letter size, while according to Allegro drawing, a letter fragment and two letters after a lacuna of at least two square letter sizes. The longest line (12:4) consists of 32 Hebrew characters.

63 *The Ancient Library of Qumran and Modern Biblical Studies*, The Haskell Lectures 1956-1957 (rev. ed.), 24; "Excursus on the Palaeographical Dating of the Copper Document," *DJD III*, 217-21; where is mentioned two paleographically similar Dead Sea documents, 4Q Cantilles<sup>b</sup> and the second hand of 1QH.

Due to similarities, often many characters are indistinguishable, especially *bet*, *kaf*, and *mem*; *dalet*, *reš*, and final *kaf*; *he*, *het*, and *taw*; *waw*, *zayin*, *yod*, and final *nun*. Often final letters are absent at the end of some words and present in the middle of others.<sup>64</sup> There are scribal corrections (*ʿalef* upon a *he*, sub- and superlinear letters, small size letters), and obvious errors (dittography, *gimmel* instead of *ʿalef* or *taw*, medial *mem* instead of a *samekh*, *waw* instead of *ʿalef* and *reš*, *reš* instead of *waw* and *yod*, etc.).<sup>65</sup>

Although some words have spaces between them, the text has no word dividers and the characters are not necessarily grouped into words. Occasionally words have letter size spaces between some of their characters, words start at the end of a line and continue on the next one, while at other places the text is in a continuous form. The last column is an different; most words are properly separated.<sup>66</sup> In addition, there are seven large lacunae (each from one to eight lines down), about a dozen smaller ones, damaged characters due to cracks and due to cutting of the rolls at their opening.

The orthography is inconsistent. Words appear in defective, full, phonetic, and other spelling forms.<sup>67</sup> The orthography resembles a few better Mishnah

64 The Talmud states, "(Scripture says twice) וְכָתַבְתֶּם ('and you shall write them' [i.e., sections of the Scripture, Deut. 6:9, 11:20; as if it were written as two words, וְכָתַב תָּם, "and a perfect writing"]), שֶׁתְּהֵא כְּתִיבָה תְּמִיָּה (that it shall be a perfect writing), that one shall not write *ʿalef* for *ʿayin*, *ʿayin* for *ʿalef* (some could not distinguish their pronunciations), *bet* for *kaf* or *kaf* for *bet*, *gimmel* for *šade* or *šade* for *gimmel*, *dalet* for *reš* or *reš* for *dalet*, *he* for *het* or *het* for *he*, *waw* for *yod* or *yod* for *waw*, *zayin* for (final) *nun* or (final) *nun* for *zayin*, *tet* for *pe* or *pe* for *tet*, bent letter or strait one or strait letter for bent one (i.e., medial *kaf*, *nun*, and *šade* for final letters, or final letters for medial ones), (final) *mem* for *samekh* or *samekh* for (final) *mem*, closed letter for open or open for closed (i.e., final *mem* for medial *mem* or medial *mem* for final *mem*)" (b. Shab. 103b; see Rashi; cf. Sifre on Deut. 6:9).

65 Some of these peculiarities were already noted by Allegro in his introduction to his preliminary reading.

66 A.R. Millard lists *square script* Hebrew texts where the words are not divided: Bene Hezir Tomb, Copper Scroll, and Phylacteries from Qumran ("Scriptio Continua' in Early Hebrew: Ancient Practice or Modern Surmise?" *JSS* 15 [1970], 10). J. Naveh says that "word division was systematically practiced in the formal Semitic writings from its very beginning in the mid-second millennium B.C., but it was neglected in short texts and non-formal scripts" ("Word Division in West Semitic Writing," *IEJ* 23 [1973], 206). At the time of the engraving of the Copper Scroll, separation of the words by spaces was already a common practice, but there also were cases of continuous script. Naveh (208) points out that "in the Copper Scroll which was written in the vulgar semi-formal style, as well as in the cursive documents from Murabbaʿat many spaces were omitted, but these are the result of neglect rather than *scriptio continua*." See also Milik, 216-17. According to the Halakhah, in writing Scripture, "one must leave out between lines as much as a line, and between words as much as a character, and between characters as much as a hair, and between columns as much as a thumb" (Sof. 2:2).

67 E.g., כָּלִין (2:6,8) vs. כָּאֵלִין (5:6; = כלים); רָאשׁ (11:5) vs. בְּרוּשׁ (= בְּרָאשׁ, 5:1); לְסַמֵּל

manuscripts, yet it deviates from the rest of the Dead Sea Scrolls, Masoretic Text, and the published Talmudic and Midrashic literatures.

Often there are interchanges between certain consonants, such as *samekh* for *sin*, *ʾalef* for *he*, final *nun* for final *mem*, and *nun* for *reš*. The latter, which has counterparts in Hebrew and other Semitic languages, was not recognized by the scroll scholars. Some of the strange *nuns* were viewed as a peculiar *reš*, while for others new words were created. The replacement of *nun* for *reš* may mirror a certain dialectical usage.

Many of the above mentioned problems might have resulted from the scant Hebrew knowledge of the engravers, and that the text originally had several blanks that were filled later, probably by a second person. These must have been done to keep the contents secret from the engravers.

Since the text is a list of hidden treasures, it is not accidental that of about 713 words, 83 are written out cardinal numbers. In addition, there are 33 sets of numerical symbols. Among the cardinal numbers there are three contracted feminine *teens*. Such teens are known in various Aramaic dialects, as well as in Akkadian. Their use in the Copper Scroll shows that at least in one Hebrew dialect, contracted teens were used.<sup>68</sup>

The Scroll contains unique words that do not occur elsewhere in Hebrew literature, words having more than one meaning, words of Aramaic, Greek, and possible Persian origin. In addition, occasionally the text has an unusual word order. These features make reading the text difficult while opening the possibility for various *legitimate* interpretations.

The Copper Scroll is a dry document of cryptic nature. It catalogs sixty descriptive units or *items* said to be hidden at various locations throughout Roman Palestine.<sup>69</sup> Each item provides some of the following information.

(1) Locus:

- (a) Hiding place; e.g., in the pit.
- (b) Further identification; e.g., the large.
- (c) Direction toward the site; e.g., which is in the north of.

(2) Site:

- (a) The site itself; e.g., Harevah.
- (b) Location of the site; e.g., in the Valley of Achor.
- (c) Further identification; e.g., above the ground.
- (d) Directional element; e.g., opposite the upper opening.

(= לשמאל, 1:13) vs. לשמאלו (10:6); שיבית for שבית (10:5).

68 This important evidence may help to reconstruct the rest of the Hebrew contracted teens, both masculine and feminine (see Appendix B).

69 Milik divides the text into 64 items, Allegro into 61, Lurie into 60, and Wise into 65. Most of the other scholars follow either Milik or Allegro. This author divides the Copper Scroll into 60 items, three of which (#9, #12, #56) can be further subdivided into two or three *sub-items*. Regarding the author's division as compared with those of Allegro, Milik-Pixner, and Lurie, see Lefkovits<sup>diss</sup> 2, 957-60.

- (3) Treasure:
  - (a) Distance; e.g., a distance of 19 cubits.
  - (b) Depth; e.g., hidden three cubits [deep].
  - (c) Description; e.g., vessels and silver.
  - (d) Weight; e.g., 10 talents.
  - (e) Number; e.g., 609 [vessels].
- (4) Additional information:
  - (a) Entrance of the hiding place; e.g., its entrance is below the western corner.
  - (b) Greek letters; e.g., TP (see Appendix C).
  - (c) Content; e.g., their numbers/notes are with them (see Appendix E).

Only a few items give detailed descriptions, the rest lack the most basic information. Most items do not mention the terms silver or gold.<sup>70</sup>

### THE LANGUAGE OF THE COPPER SCROLL

The language of the Copper Scroll can be classified as being proto-Mishnaic Hebrew. It resembles 4QMMT (Miqṣat Ma'aseh haTorah, "Some Rulings Pertaining to the Torah"), some Bar-Kokhba letters (second cent. CE), and Mishnaic Hebrew (third cent. CE).<sup>71</sup> Therefore, Copper Scroll Hebrew may

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70 This writer in 1979, as part of his defense of his doctoral thesis proposal, prepared a detailed chart of eleven columns, "The Copper Scroll: Its Literary Pattern," as well as "Glossary of the Copper Scroll," "Concordance of the Copper Scroll," and "Word List with an English Translation of the Copper Scroll." Later he also prepared, "Linear Fluent Translation of the Copper Scroll Parallel to the Hebrew Text." These were not included in the author's dissertation, because it was already voluminous. An updated version of these items, as well as an updated discussion of "The Grammar of the Copper Scroll" (see "Grammatical Peculiarities of the Copper Scroll" in Lefkovits<sup>diss</sup> 2, 962-1054), also, "Word Index of the Copper Scroll by Items," are not included in this work, because of the limited space available. They have been deferred for later publication. It should be added, Wolters in a chart analyzes in a different fashion the Copper Scroll ("Literary Analysis and the Copper Scroll," *Intertestamental Essays in Honor of Józef Tadeusz Milik* [1992], 239-52; "The Copper Scroll," *The Dead Sea Scroll After Fifty Years* [1998], 305, 314-23).

71 The scholars point out the the language of the Copper Scroll is either Mishnaic Hebrew or closely related to it. E.g., R. de Vaux, referring to the Copper Scroll, says, "From every point of view it is different from the generality of the manuscripts at Qumran. It is the only document engraved on metal, and the only text in Mishnaic Hebrew. In content it does not conform to any of the literary *genres* attested at Qumran" (*Archaeology and the Dead Sea Scrolls* [1973], 108). Abba Bendavid (98-99) states that the language of the Copper Scroll is almost Mishnaic Hebrew. S. Sharvit concludes that the language of the Copper Scroll is closely related to Mishnaic Hebrew ("Iyyunim," 135; "He'arah le'Iyyunim," 151). S. Morag categorizes the Hebrew of the Dead Sea Scrolls as *General Qumran Hebrew* (majority of the texts), *Copper Scroll Hebrew*, and *Qumran Mishnaic* (including MMT), ("Qumran Hebrew: Some Topological Observations," VT 38 [1988], 148-64). Qimron says, "MH already existed as a spoken language before the destruction of the Second Temple. Yet 4QMMT, whose language is most similar to MH and presumably best reflects the spoken Hebrew of Qumran, differs markedly from MH in its grammar" (p. 117). Moreover, in

represent a link between late Biblical and early Mishnaic Hebrew.

The language of most non-biblical Dead Sea Hebrew scrolls resembles Late Biblical Hebrew, their authors apparently imitated Biblical Hebrew. However, the Copper Scroll is an exception, and this is understandable. It is a list of hidden objects, written in the language of its compilers, without mimicking Biblical Hebrew. This is also true concerning MMT and the Bar-Kokhba letters. Likewise, the Mishnah and Tosephta were written in the vernacular used at the academies when Hebrew was still a living language.<sup>72</sup>

There are similarities between the Copper Scroll and Megillat Ta'anit. Although the latter is written in Tannaic Aramaic, its style resembles that of the Copper Scroll. Both employ non-contracted and contracted teens, a feature found in the Hebrew literature only in the Copper Scroll (see Appendix B).

Finally, the various proto-Mishnaic dialects used in the Copper Scroll, MMT, and the Bar-Kokhba documents establishes that Mishnaic Hebrew was indeed a living language, not artificially created by the Rabbis of the Mishnaic era, as some scholars suggest.<sup>73</sup>

### APPROACH USED IN THIS STUDY

This study differs radically from all of those previously published. It seeks

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MMT the relative אשר occurs only once (line 37), while ש, ש- and של are used several times; e.g., בשל שלא ינהי (line 12); בשל שא יהיה (line 16; the lines are according to R. Eisenman and M. Wise, *Dead Sea Scrolls Uncovered* [1992], 190-92). Milik in his discussion of the orthography of the Copper Scroll refers to the six manuscripts of MMT which he designates as "4Qmišn(ique)<sup>a</sup> ... mišn<sup>f</sup>." Thus, Milik considers the language of MMT as Mishnaic Hebrew. He even cites two long passages (which include partial reconstruction of two words) without any translation or further elaboration of their meanings (Milik, 222 B, 223 B-1a, 225 B-2a). This shows that more than 22 years before the existence of MMT became known in 1984, Milik already had a good knowledge of its text. This supports the allegation that some scholars deliberately delayed the publication of MMT, as well as other Qumran material.

72 E.Y. Kutscher divides Mishnaic Hebrew into: (1) Mishnaic Hebrew of the Tanna'im (until 200 CE), while it was still a living language. This is subdivided into (a) Palestinian Tannaic and (b) Babylonian Tannaic. (2) Mishnaic Hebrew of the Amoraim (200-500 CE), when it was no more a spoken language. This is subdivided into: (a) Palestinian Amoraic and (b) Babylonian Amoraic. Kutscher adds two more subgroups: (c) the languages of the prayers; and (d) loans from Biblical in Mishnaic Hebrew which is actually not Mishnaic ("Some Problems of the Lexicography of Mishnaic Hebrew and its Comparison with Biblical Hebrew" [in Heb.], *Archive* 1 (1972), 40, Eng. Sum. xiv-xv; "Hebrew Language ...," *EJ* 16, 1591, 1606-07); "עברית, לשון (לשון חז"ל)" in *EH* 26, 645.

73 E.g., according to A. Geiger (1810-74), who was the first to write a scientific grammar of Mishnaic Hebrew, Mishnaic Hebrew was an artificial language created and used by the Rabbis to facilitate Halakhic discussions at their academies (cf. E.Y. Kutscher, "Hebrew Language," *EJ* 16, 1592-93).

where possible to comprehend the text without any preconceived bias. To obtain a valid understanding of the Scroll, one must view it in its proper historical context. The Copper Scroll is a non-literary document that was created in a cultural and social milieu that produced the early Rabbinic literature of Megillat Ta'anit, Mishnah, Tosephta, Tannaic Midrashim, and Targumim, although these were not yet committed to writing. The same epoch yielded the Dead Sea Scrolls, including the Apocryphal fragments.

The Dead Sea Scrolls are of less significance for an understanding of the Copper Scroll than the early Rabbinic literature (with few exceptions, e.g., the Temple Scroll, MMT, some Bar-Kokhba letters). The works of Josephus and part of the New Testament also originated during this era, however, they were written essentially for a non-Jewish audience and for different purposes.

For the aforementioned reasons, as well as based on linguistic and semantic grounds, this study relies heavily on the Mishnah, Tosephta, Midrashim, Targumim, and of course, on the Masoretic Text. In addition, both Talmudim were intensively consulted, although they belong to a later time. They expound on the Mishnah and contain many baraitas (Tannaic traditions excluded from the Mishnah).<sup>74</sup> Emphasis on traditional Rabbinic sources does not imply that the Dead Sea Scrolls, the works of Josephus, etc., were disregarded. On the contrary, they were given careful consideration along with much older and later inscriptions or documents, such as Ugaritic, Phoenician, Punic, Aramaic, Hebrew, Moabite, Elephantine, Punic, Bar-Kokhba, even Cairo Genizah materials, and payṭanic literature.

To study and properly understand the readings and interpretations by the various scholars of the Copper Scroll, the following methodology was used. The transliteration of the Hebrew text in Allegro's first publication was re-transliterated back to Hebrew. In the latter regular letters in final position, and final letters in middle position were used in accordance with Allegro's drawings, since this was the system used in "Allegro's Provisional Translation and Notes on the Copper Scroll." Regarding the latter, the translation was reconstructed back into Hebrew based on the notes which contains many Hebrew words, as well as Allegro's transliteration and notes in his first publication of the Scroll. Allegro's second revised English translation, based on his earlier works and on Milik's reading, was reconstructed back to Hebrew. Milik's reading in the Commentary are given with his English translation, yet his French version, his *pre-editio princeps* translations, as well as Greenfield's highly critical review of Milik's work were consulted. Lurie's Modern Hebrew translation was translated into English.<sup>75</sup> Pixner's English translation

<sup>74</sup> This author's approach is similar to that used by Gevaryahu, Lurie, Lehmann, and Greenfield.

<sup>75</sup> Allegro's second edition and Lurie's book were published almost simultaneously. It appears that Allegro was not aware of Lurie's work, nor was Lurie familiar with Allegro's

was reconstructed back into Hebrew by incorporating the transliteration of his reading of about a third of the text, and with the help of the readings of Allegro, Milik, and Lurie. The same method was used concerning the alternate readings and translations offered by these scholars. Wolters final readings and translations were used, and often was compared to suggestions in his earlier publications. Beyer's German translation was translated into English.<sup>76</sup> Also taken into consideration was the translations of Garcia Martinez, Vermes, Wise, as well as the partial readings or translations of others, such as Lehmann, Wilmot, Mandel, McCarter, and Muchowski.

The various readings, reconstructed readings, and translations of the Copper Scroll, as well as the suggestions of many analysts, were compared to one another,<sup>77</sup> to the three published drawings,<sup>78</sup> to the photographs published by Milik,<sup>79</sup> to the photographs received from Jerusalem made from the negatives of Milik's published photographs,<sup>80</sup> to the photographs received from the Archaeological Museum of Amman in Jordan,<sup>81</sup> and to a number of the new photographs by the Zuckermans.<sup>82</sup>

revised edition.

76 This was done by this author, perhaps occasionally some errors were made.

77 It is very important to be alert and recognize possible typographical errors in published material, especially regarding the Copper Scroll. Some have been unjustly criticized for obvious typographical errors in their publications. Therefore, most of the numerous typographical errors in these readings used in this work were corrected and noted. Some errors are common feature in the process of publishing scholarly works (including this one).

78 The three drawings are: Baker's (*DJD III*, xlv), Milik's (which is a corrected version of Baker's; *DJD III*, xlviii, l, lii, liv, lvi, lviii, lx, lxii, lxiv, lxvi, lxviii, lxx), and of Allegro (32, 34, 36, 38, 40, 42, 44, 46, 48, 50, 52, 54). The drawing segments in the work of Lurie (53, 59-60, 62, 65, 67-70, 72-74, 76, 78-83, 85-88, 90, 92, 94-99, 101-102, 108-10, 112-15, 117-26) are poor copies of Allegro's drawing. In this work, usually the singular form is used; e.g., Baker's drawing, Milik's drawing, and Allegro's drawing.

79 *DJD III*, xlix, li, liii, lv, lvii, lix, lxi, lxiii, lxv, lxvii, lxix, lxxi.

80 These photographs the author received in 1978 through the courtesy of Prof. B.A. Levine (New York University), Mr. M. Broshi (Curator of the Shrine of the Book, Jerusalem), and the late Pierre Benoit (École Biblique et Archéologique Française, Jerusalem).

81 These were received in 1978 by the author from the Archaeological Museum of Amman through the courtesy of Prof. F. Peters (New York University). These resemble the photographs published in *The Allegro Qumran Collection* (ed. by G.J. Brooke, 1996).

82 B. Zuckerman, who with his brother made magnificent photographs of the Copper Scroll, plans to publish new drawings of the Scroll (personal communication). The scroll segments of Zuckermans material are the same size as the original. It is especially useful that each segment was photographed from both the front and reverse sides. A similar approach was proposed by the author many years ago (see Lefkovits<sup>diss</sup> 1, 57-58). See B. and K. Zuckerman, "Photographing the Copper Scroll," *BR* 8 (1992), 37 (inlet); also P.K. McCarter, Jr., "The Mysterious Copper Scroll, Clues to Hidden Temple Treasure?" *BR* 8 (1992), 37b-38a; "The Mystery of the Copper Scroll," *Understanding the Dead Sea Scrolls* (1992), 232-33. Moreover, Electricité de France has recently reconstructed the Copper

Each of the three published drawings of the Scroll has twelve sections or columns. The characters in Milik's drawings were drawn with a thick pointed pen, while Allegro's with a much thinner one. Each column in Milik's drawings is about 25-26 cm high, while Allegro's about 14.5-15.5 cm. To compare the drawings with each other, the following method was used. Milik's drawings were reduced by about 40%. Each segment of Baker's drawings is about 6.6-7.1 cm high. They were blown up to slightly more than twice their size. Allegro's drawings were copied on transparent sheets. For comparative purposes, each of these transparent copies was placed over the reduced copy of Milik's and the blown up one of Baker's drawings of the same segment. Just slowly moving Allegro's transparent copies over Milik's reduced and Baker's enlarged copies, the differences become noticeable between the drawings. This method permitted evaluation of the possible readings of the text. It also helped to facilitate a better understanding of the reasoning by the scholars that led to their suggestions.<sup>83</sup>

Regarding the text, the maximum number of possible readings, vocalizations, and interpretations were presented and evaluated, including most of those by the scholars, as well completely new ones. These multiplicity of readings created such problems that often it was impossible to decide which should be selected, which should be listed as alternates, and in which order should they be presented. Many words and phrases have multiple readings, vocalizations, and interpretations; for some, there is more than a dozen. This explains the many alternate suggestions given.

The possible readings were compared to materials from the Masoretic Text, Mishnah, Tosephta, Talmudim, Midrashim, and Targumim (including Samaritans), also Akkadian, Ugaritic, Phoenician, Punic, Neo-Punic, Ya'u-

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Scroll, and shortly will make available new drawings. In 1978, the late Wilmot claimed that he was able to trace the published photographs of Milik, and made new drawings (personal communication; see Lefkovits<sup>diss</sup> 1, 84-85). It should be added that where the appearance of the three drawings are identical, it is almost certain that this is an accurate rendition of the Scroll, and most probably the new drawings will be confirmatory. Where the drawings differ, the new drawings could be decisive in determining the most accurate rendition. However, where the questionable reading is at the edge of a cut, crack, or lacuna, due to the deterioration of the segments, the new drawings and even the reconstruction of the Scroll might not provide enough help. In such cases, one will have to rely exclusively on the original drawings and photographs. It is the author's opinion that greater accuracy of the drawings and readings could have been achieved had impressions been made of the reverse side of the copper rolls after cleaning but prior to their being cut into segments, and after cutting and cleaning the front side of each segment (see "Reflection on the Opening of the Scroll" in the Discussion, also cf. Lefkovits<sup>diss</sup> 1, 10-11). Regarding the deterioration of the segments, see P.K. McCarter, "The Mysterious Copper Scroll, Clues to Hidden Temple Treasure?" *BR* 8 [1992], 34-41, 63-64.

83 See also "The Drawings" in the Discussion.

dic, Hebrew, Aramaic, Moabite, Ammonite inscriptions, Elephantine Aramaic documents, Dead Sea Scrolls, Babylonian Jewish Aramaic Magic Bowls, prayers, *piyyutim*,<sup>84</sup> and other source material.

In addition, traditional Biblical, Talmudic, Midrashic, Targumic, prayer, *piyyut*, Halakhah commentators, and grammarians,<sup>85</sup> as well as modern biblical, Rabbinic, and Christian sources were utilized. Essentially all quotations were verified with their primary sources, then translated into English. In doing so, voluminous translations,<sup>86</sup> dictionaries,<sup>87</sup> concordances,<sup>88</sup> grammar books,<sup>89</sup> and works on related subjects<sup>90</sup> were consulted.

To help solve the problems with many unique words of the text, the letter interchange method was employed extensively. In the Semitic languages occasionally a letter of a given root or word is understood to be interchanged with another one. Most of these are phonetic interchanges occurring within the same group of sounds,<sup>91</sup> while others are apparently unrelated.<sup>92</sup> Al-

84 These are religious poems for public worship composed by the *paytanim*, into which are incorporated biblical, Talmudic, and Midrashic interpretations.

85 E.g., 'Amar Neqē', *Be'er Rehovot*, *Be'er Yishaq*, Bekhor Shor, Bertinoro, *Beth Levi*, *Be'urei Onkelos*, *Da'ai Zeqeinim*, Eliah Levita, Ga'on of Vilna, *Hakketav wehaqQabbalah*, Hayyim ben Bezalel of Friedburg, *Hizquni*, Ibn-Ezra, Ibn-Janah, Ibn-Saruq, Joseph Kimhi, Kehati, *Keli Yaqar*, *Lehem weSimlah*, *Ma'amar Yom-Tov*, *Ma'aseh 'Oreg*, *Mahzor Vitri*, *Matteh Levi*, Maimonides, Malbim, *Mar'eh hapPanim*, *Mešudat David*, *Mešudat Zion*, Nahmanides, *Penei Moshe*, *Peruš Jonathan*, Rabbeinu Hananel, Rabbeinu Gershom, Rabbeinu Meyuhas, Rabbeinu Nissim, Radak, Ralbag, Rash, Rashbam, Rashi, Rid, Rik, Sa'adiah Ga'on, Sforno, *Tif'eret Israel*, *Torah Temimah*, Tosaphot, *Tosephot Yom-Tov*. See also "Rabbinical Sources" in the Frontmatter, Kaplan's "Bibliography" at the end of his *The Living Torah*, 1383-1407, and "Abbreviations Used in Rabbinical Literature," *EJ* 1, 74-79.

86 E.g., ArtScroll (*Tanach*, Babylonian Talmud, Rashi on Torah), *JPS*, Kaplan, Koren, Neusner, Sconcino (Scripture, Babylonian Talmud), Yehoash (in Yiddish).

87 E.g., *Sefer he'Arukh* by Rabbi Nathan of Rome, and its related works by Ephraim Zalman haLevi of Vilna, Ginzberg, Kohut, Krauss, Schlesinger, Eliah (*Arukh haqQasar*; see BenJacob, *Ozar ha-Sepharim*, 1880, 450b-51a). Also the works by Almalih, Aistleitner, Ben-Yehuda, BDB, Even-Shoshan, Frank, Gordon, Harkavy, Jastrow, Karo, Koehler and Baumgartner, Krupnik and Silbermann, Levy, Melamed, Payne Smith and Margaliouth, Sokoloff, Sperber, Steinberg; as well as Catane, Greenberg, Gukovitzki (the last three are based on the works of Blondheim and Darmesteter).

88 Even-Shoshan, Mandelkern, and the numerous concordances of the Kasovsky/Kasow-ski/Kosovsky Family (spelling of the name varies).

89 E.g., by Bendavid, Bergsträsser, (B.Z.) Cohen, (H.R.) Cohen, Cross and Freedman, Epstein, Frank, Fränkel, Gesenius, Ginsberg, (C.H.) Gordon, Goshen-Gottstein, (S.Z.) Hanau, Harris, (A.) Kahana, Kutscher, Lambdin, Leviaš, Moscati, Qimron, Rath, Rosenthal, Šadaqah, Segal, Stark, Stevenson, (R.D.) Wilson, Yelin.

90 E.g., by Barkali, Donner and Röllig, Carmel, Ben-Hayyim, Epstein, Fränkel, Gordis, (C.H.) Gordon, Krauss, Luzzatto (= Shadal), Rabinowich, Šadaqah.

91 Such as sonorous: למנ"ש; dentals: זסצ"ש; gutturals: אהח"ע; palatals: גיכ"ק; linguals: דטטלנ"ת; labials: בוּמ"ף; vowel letters: אהו"י. E.g., אָעַק vs. אָעַץ, "he cried."

92 E.g., אָרְצָא vs. אָרְצָא, "the land"; šade-*ayin-qof* interchange; the first word is Hebrew, the second and third are Aramaic.

though the letter interchanges occur more often between the languages, the same may also occur within a given language.<sup>93</sup>

The method of letter interchanges to determine the meaning of rare biblical words already had been used in Tannaic times,<sup>94</sup> by Bible and Talmud commentators and grammarians,<sup>95</sup> as well as modern lexicographers.<sup>96</sup> It is especially important to mention the phonetic interchange of *nun* and *reš* which was heretofore not recognized by the students of the Copper Scroll.

## VOCALIZATION

The Copper Scroll item under discussion is presented initially unvocalized. However, in the Commentary words and phrases are for the most part vocalized. This is also true for citations from various Hebrew, Aramaic, Samaritan Hebrew and Aramaic, Moabite, Phoenician, Punic, Neo-Punic, Ugaritic, Old-Aramaic, Mandaic, etc. sources. These are often presented in parentheses with an equal sign, and reflect the traditional Hebrew and Aramaic vocalizations. This is done for easier reading and understanding, and does not mean that the text in question was pronounced in this manner.

In most scholarly publication ancient Hebrew, Aramaic, Ugaritic, Phoenician, Punic, etc. texts are left unvocalized.<sup>97</sup> This has an advantage to the author, since nobody can criticize the suggested vocalization, which is often only an educated guess.

After considerable thought it was for three reasons decided to vocalize the various text used in the Commentary. (1) It can greatly benefit the reader, especially those uninitiated in the subject. (2) It can often clearly pinpoint subtle meaning of a word, where it may change the understanding the text as a whole. (3) It can provide the author's understanding of a given word or

93 E.g., Hebrew *שָׁלשׁ* vs. Aramaic *תלת*, "three"; *חָרַשׁ* vs. *חָרַת*, "he engraved," both in Hebrew (*šin-taw* interchange).

94 E.g., Rule 29 in the Baraita of the Thirty-Two Rules by Rabbi Eliazar son of Rabbi Yose hagGelili (which can be found in the Talmud editions after the Tractate Berakhot, and in the introduction of better editions of Midrash Rabbah).

95 E.g., Rashi, discussing the the connection between *רָכַל*, "gossiping," and *רָגַל*, "to spy," list many letter interchanges, *bet-pe-waw*, *gimmel-kaf-qof*, *nun-lamed*, *reš-zayin-šade* (Lev. 19:16; see Herczeg, *Leviticus*, 236 and n. 7, 237 and nn. 1-8).

96 E.g., J. Steinberg extensively uses this method in his Bible dictionary *Millon hat-Tenakh* (= SB); also cf. C.H. Gordon, *UT* 1, 30.

97 There are exceptions; e.g., E. Lohse, *Die Texte aus Qumran* (1971); S. Ahituv, *Handbook of Ancient Hebrew Inscriptions From the period of the First Commonwealth and the Beginning of the Second Commonwealth* (1992); Y. Aharoni, "שלושה אוסטרוקונים עבריים מארד", in *EI* 9 (1969), 11, 15-17; the Ugaritic *Mrzḥ* text has been vocalized by P.D. Miller, "The *MRZḤ* Text"; and M. Dahood, "Additional Notes on the *MRZḤ* Text," *The Claremont Rash Shamra Tablets* (1971), 37-38 and 51, respectively.

phrase, especially in a text, such as the Copper Scroll, where numerous alternate possible readings and vocalizations are offered. E.g., כְּבוֹר, can be vocalized as follows. כְּבוֹר, “in a cistern,” “in a pit,” or “in a burial pit,” which indicates that in that *specific location* there were more than one cistern, pit, or burial pit, and this is one of them. And כְּבוֹר, the contracted form of כְּהַבוֹר, “in the cistern,” “in the pit,” or “in the burial pit,” i.e., a *specific cistern, pit, or burial pit*.<sup>98</sup>

In general, the vocalizations of Hebrew and Aramaic words are based on the Masoretic Text transmitted by the Tiberian *Masoretes*.<sup>99</sup> Most Targumim are also vocalized. Although one can discern various systems that may reveal different dialects and/or pronunciations, some of these are conflicting, while others are only variations. There are several vocalized Mishnah manuscripts, such as Kaufmann,<sup>100</sup> Parma.<sup>101</sup> These may reflect certain traditions, and are not exactly like the Tiberian Masoretic style would render.

Mishnaic vocalization should reflect Mishnaic Hebrew usage, which significantly differs from Biblical Hebrew, whether it is pre- or post-exilic. The Mishnah material used in this work basically follows the vocalization found in Kehati's edition.<sup>102</sup> The vocalization of Tosephta, Talmudim, Midrashim, as well as post-Talmudic Hebrew and Aramaic materials frequently are based on vocalized editions, as well as on various dictionaries.<sup>103</sup>

It is very difficult and tedious to vocalize material. This is especially true regarding the Copper Scroll, where the text haphazardly employs defective, *plene* (i.e., full), unusual, and non-standard spellings. Many of these have parallels in unusual Masoretic forms (especially *ketiv* cases, i.e., the way how it is written), Dead Sea Scrolls, Mishnaic orthography, etc. Moreover,

98 E.g., כְּבוֹר־בְּבוֹר שְׁנֵי הַשְּׁעָרִים הָמֶזְרָחִי, “In a/the cistern/(burial) pit which is opposite to the eastern gate” (2:7); כְּבוֹר־בְּבוֹר שֶׁתַּחַת הַחוֹמָה, “In/at/by a/the cistern/(burial) pit which is below the city-wall” (see #10, 2:10). Rashi points out that every prefixed *beth* and *lamed* vocalized with a *pataḥ*, as well as the prefixed *he*, refer to a known thing mentioned elsewhere, or it is obvious regarding the subject matter (Rashi on Gen. 24:27; see Herczeg, *Genesis*, 255 and n. 3; Y.E. Auerbach, *Be'er Rehovot* [1877/78], 28; M.H. Haraz, *Lešon Hayyim* [1975/76], 64; Y.S. Weinfeld, *Mišnat Ya'aqov* [1981/82], 32-33).

99 There are other but lesser known vocalization systems, such as Palestinian, Babylonian. The Ashkenazic pronunciation may reflect the Tiberian system (which distinguishes, for example, between *qamaš* and *pataḥ*, *šere* and *seḡol*), while the Sepharadi pronunciation the Babylonian system.

100 G. Beer, *Mischnacodex Kaufmann A 50*; it is completely vocalized, and probably by a Sepharadi vocalizer.

101 *Parma Mishnah Manuscript, De Rossi No. 138*; it is partially vocalized, and probably by a Sepharadi vocalizer.

102 P. Kehati, *Mišnayot Mevo'arot* (1977). It appears that his vocalized text is based on the vocalization of Hanokh Yalon (= Henech Distenfeld [1886-1970]; published together with the Mishnah commentary of Hanokh Albeck [1890-1972], in 1952-58).

103 See “Approach Used in this Study.”

one can not be sure how to vocalize even relatively simple words. For example, the term חפור, which occurs 22 times in the Scroll, is spelled in four different ways: חפר (defective), חפור (plene), חפּוּר (double waw), and חפּוֹן (plene plus a *nun-reš* interchange). It can be vocalized as חָפַר, חֶפֶר, חֶפּוּר, חֶפּוֹן, “it is hidden/buried” (*Qal* masc. sg. pass. part.), or חָפַר, חֶפֶר, חֶפּוּר, and חֶפּוֹן, “dig” (*Qal*, masc. sg. imperative; see #17, 4:7).

The double *waw* and *yod* spellings are only variant orthographic representations, that may indicate consonantal values. In these cases only the first letter is vocalized. E.g., the possible readings and vocalizations of אָשׁוּרֹת (= אָשׁוּרָה, אָשׁוּרָה (= אָשׁוּרָה), אָשׁוּרִית (= אָשׁוּרִית), or אָשׁוּרִית (= אָשׁוּרִית). Even when the *waw* or *yod* has a *dageš forte* and double letter would take care of it, still the first letter is vocalized with the *dageš* (see #22, 5:6; #48, 10:3).

Finally, Biblical Hebrew employs pausal forms, such as כָּסַף instead of כֶּסֶף (e.g., Gen. 37:28). It is a question whether Mishnaic Hebrew used pausal forms at all. Such cases in the Commentary are vocalized with the regular form, except citations from the Masoretic text.<sup>104</sup>

### FORMAT OF THE COMMENTARY

The text of the Copper Scroll has been divided into sixty items, and each is discussed separately, as if it were a distinct chapter. Each item is analyzed basically in the following manner.

- (1) The Hebrew text contains:
  - (a) The proposed readings (alternate readings are given in the Commentary).
  - (b) Obvious scribal errors are corrected; e.g., עסרה rather than עמרה as in the text.
  - (c) 'Alef instead of *he* in final position is left unchanged; e.g., בברכא for בברכה.
  - (d) Final letters in medial position are left unchanged; e.g., פנת for פנת.
  - (e) Medial letters in final position are left unchanged; e.g., בירך for בירך.
  - (f) *Plene* spellings are left unchanged; e.g., ניקרת for ניקרת.
  - (g) Defective spellings are left unchanged; e.g., חפר for חפר.
  - (h) Phonetic spelling is left unchanged; e.g., שלמה for שלמו.
  - (i) Non-standard spelling is left unchanged; e.g., הבאות for הבאות.
  - (j) Letter interchanges are left unchanged; e.g., חפון for חפון.
  - (k) Interrupted words are indicated by a hyphen in between angle brackets; e.g., <-> כח at the end of the line and לת at the beginning of the next line (= כחלת).

<sup>104</sup> In the citations of the Masoretic Text, the *maqfeš* were omitted for technical reasons. A *maqfeš* is a vertical line (ʾ) connecting a word (often a preposition) to the next one, making them into a single unit, and only the last word keeps its original accent. It can also be found between several words in continuity. Often long vocals are reduced due to the *maqfeš*, e.g., וְכָל-הָעוֹף לְמִינֵהוּ כָל-צֹפֹר כָּל-כָּנָף, “and every fowl after its (masc.) kind, every bird, every winged creature” (Gen. 7:14).

- (l) Restored letters or words are placed in between square brackets; e.g., [ככר] (= ככר); ח[פזר אמות תשע] (= חפזר אמות תשע).
  - (m) Dittographs are placed in between curly brackets; e.g., {מ}.
  - (n) Restored missing letters due to scribal errors are placed in between angle brackets; e.g., <דמע> (= דמע).
  - (o) Non-restored texts are indicated by three dots; e.g., [... תשע ככ].
  - (p) Dots above the characters indicating probable letters, small circles above the characters indicating possible letters, and small *o*'s indicating unreadable letters, are used only for quoted material; e.g., רִבְנָה הַשְׁלֵשִׁי, דְּבִהֹשׁוֹ. Since many letters can be read more than one way, and often letters are damaged, their usage would confuse the reader, yet they are discussed in the Commentary.
  - (r) The Greek letters are given as they appear.
- (2) The English translation contains:
- (a) A linear and almost literal translation (alternate translations are given in the Commentary).
  - (b) Restored letters or words are placed in between square brackets; e.g., "[talents]"; "bu[ried] nine [cubits]."
  - (c) Restored missing letters due to scribal errors are placed in between angle brackets; e.g., "dedica <ted >."
  - (d) Words needed for translation are placed in between parenthesis; e.g., "(there are)."
  - (e) Words needed for further explanations are placed in between parenthesis; e.g., "(deep)."
  - (f) Non-restored texts or numerals are often indicated by three dots; e.g., "nine [cubits] (deep) ... k(arsh of [s(ilver)])."
  - (g) Greek letters are given as they appear, but "(Code:)" is added before them; e.g., "(Code:) XAI" (they are discussed in Appendix C).
- (3) The Commentary contains:
- (a) Vocalized subheadings of words or phrases, are indicated by column and line numbers, and are followed by translations; e.g., (1:2) תַּחַת הַמַּעֲלוֹת, "below the steps."
  - (b) Alternate readings or vocalizations are indicated by slashes; e.g., בְּנִפְשׁוֹ בְּנִפְשׁוֹ, בְּשׁוֹחַ בְּשִׁיחַ בְּשִׁיחַ.
  - (c) The standard spellings are with the equal sign, often within parenthesis; e.g., בְּצִפּוֹן (= בְּצִפּוֹן).
  - (d) Indications of scribal error; e.g., "the text has עֲמַרָה for עֲסַרָה (*mem* instead of *samekh*)."
  - (e) Discussion of the various drawings and occasionally photographs; e.g., Baker, Milik, Allegro, Zuckermans.
  - (f) Discussion of the readings, alternate readings, and their translations by the scholars; e.g., Allegro, Milik, Lurie, Pixner.
  - (g) Assumed Hebrew reading of the scholars where only the translation is given and it is needed for comparison or explanation are indicated in

parenthesis; e.g., "(i.e., כלי דמע)."

- (h) New readings, alternate readings, their vocalizations, and translations. These are discussed and compared with similar cases in the Scroll, Masoretic Text, Mishnah, Tosephta, Midrashim, Targumim, Talmudim, and their commentaries, Dead Sea Scrolls, Elephantine Documents, inscriptions, etc.
- (i) Alternate translations are indicated by slashes; e.g., "in/at/by."
- (j) Translations of alternate readings are indicated by slashes; e.g., "sepulcher/ditch/Regeb/Negeb."
- (k) Possible singular or plural translations are indicted in parentheses; e.g., "(a vessel(s)"; i.e., a vessel or vessels.
- (l) Simple cross reference; e.g., "9:4"; i.e., column 9, line 4.
- (m) Cross reference with discussion (often enclosed in parentheses); e.g., "(see #55, 11:12)"; i.e., see Item 55, column 11, line 12.
- (n) Extensive footnotes.

The Commentary is followed by five Appendices dealing at length with several especially important topics. This is followed by a Word Index of the Copper Scroll, which includes all words, but not alternates, as they appear in the Scroll in alphabetical order indicated by column, line, and item numbers. Lastly, there is an extensive up-to-date Bibliography.

One can compare the author's study of possible readings, vocalizations, and interpretations of the text, with the traditional Talmud study system utilized in the Yeshivah world. There the Talmud is analyzed with the help of various commentators whose interpretations often conflict with one another. The student (*baḥur*) is, nevertheless, obligated to study most of them, while he is free to accept whichever view he desires. Similarly, in this extensive study the reader can choose any of the alternate suggestions, not necessarily the one proposed here, and even can come up with new solutions. Often the author himself was in a dilemma which of several reasonable possibilities to select (e.g., the problematic phrase בתכנכתבן אצלמן, which occurs five times in the Scroll, can be read, vocalized, and translated numerous ways; see Appendix E).

The Commentary, as well as the Appendices, permit independent study of any segment of the text. Since essentially all quotations are translated and often explained, the Commentary and Appendices are cross referenced, this format should facilitate gaining a better insight into the mystery of the Copper Scroll, especially for those who are not knowledgeable in this field.

## ITEM 1

|                          |     |
|--------------------------|-----|
| בחרובהא שבעמק עכור תחת   | 1:1 |
| המעלות הבואת למזרח אמות  | 1:2 |
| אחת ארבעין שדת כסף וכליה | 1:3 |
| משקל ככרין שבעשרה KEN    | 1:4 |

- 1:1 In the ruin which is in the Valley of Achor, below  
 1:2 the steps that are going to east, (at) forty  
 1:3 one cubits, (there is) a silver carrying chair with its  
 components,  
 1:4 a weight of seventeen talents. (Code:) KEN.

## COMMENTARY

(1:1) בַּחֲרוּבָהּ וְאִבְחַר־יָבֵהּ וְאֵשֶׁבַע־מֶקַּע עֶכּוֹר "In/at/by (a/the) ruin/Ḥaruvah/Ḥarevah which is in/at/by (the) Valley of Achor" — ALLEGRO<sup>P</sup>: "In the ruin which is in the Valley of 'Achor." ALLEGRO: בַּחֲרוּבָהּ שֶׁבַע־מֶקַּע עֶכּוֹר, "In the fortress which is in the Vale of Achor." <sup>'alef</sup> for *he* as often in the Scroll. חֲרוּבָהּ, cf. Isa. 58:12; Ezek. 36:18, 38:12; Ps. 109:10; Job 3:14; also, *mhrb(n)*, "castle, fortified place" (South-Arabian), *mihrabun*, "pavilion, palace" (Arabic), and the toponyms חֲרוּבָהּ, Harubah, and מִגְדַּל חֲרוּב, Tower of Harub. Vale of Achor is identified with Buqeia, while Harubah may lie behind the medieval *Solitudo Ruba*; etc.<sup>1</sup> מִלִּיק: בַּחֲרִיבָה שֶׁבַע־מֶקַּע עֶכּוֹר, "At Horebbeh, situated in the Valley of Achor." Valley of Achor (also written as עֶמֶק עֶכּוֹן, 4:6; cf. 1 Chron. 2:7) is not the Biblical Valley of Trouble, rather it is Wadi Nuwei'imah, northeast of Jericho. חֲרִיבָה, "small ruin," is Choremba near Jericho, where a monastery was mentioned by John Moschus; etc. The scribe corrected the <sup>'alef</sup> into a *he*.<sup>2</sup> לִירִי: בַּחֲרוּבָהּ שֶׁבַע־מֶקַּע עֶכּוֹר, "In the (settlement of) Ḥaruva which is in the Valley of Achor." חֲרוּבָהּ is named after the חֲרוּב, "carob tree." For the Valley of Achor, cf. Josh. 7:24-26, 15:10; etc. Valley of Achor is not Buqeia, it is near Jericho. חֲרוּבָהּ does not mean "fortress" (Allegro). The reading is חֲרוּבָהּ not חֲרִיבָהּ (as Milik), i.e., *waw* and <sup>'alef</sup> rather than *yod* and *he*.<sup>3</sup> The latter raises some

1 Allegro, 33, 134 nn. 1-2 (חֲרוּבָהּ instead of חֲרוּבָהּ, and מִגְדַּל חֲרוּבָהּ instead of מִגְדַּל חֲרוּב, are typographical errors); Allegro<sup>rev</sup>, 21.

2 Milik<sup>F</sup>, 323, 330-33; Milik<sup>ET</sup>, 566-67; Milik<sup>E</sup>, 139, 143-44; Milik, 284-85, 257 C-200, 262-63 D-3-4.

3 Lurie, 53-55 and nn. 1-2, 58.

questions concerning Lurie's methodology. (1) It is practically impossible to distinguish between *waw* and *yod* in the Scroll. (2) *'Alef* and *he*, as well as *waw* and *yod*, are interchangeable. (3) Both *'alef* and *he* were punched one upon the other. PIXNER: "At the ruin (בחרובה) which is in the Valley (עמק) go past (עבור)." The valley is the upper section of Gehinnom called עמק (Jer. 31:40). עבור refers to the distance mentioned afterward, and it is better than עכור, since later it is called עכון; why two spellings for the name in the same document?<sup>4</sup> WOLTERS and WISE follow Allegro<sup>pt</sup>, GARCIA MARTINEZ is like Pixner, while WACHOLDER, BEYER and VERMES agree with Milik.<sup>5</sup>

The first word demonstrates the inherent difficulty in reading, vocalizing, and interpreting this document. Each of its letters can be read in more than one way: *bet/kaf*, *he/het/taw*, *dalet/reš*, *waw/zayin/yod/final nun*, *bet/kaf*, and an *'alef* punched on an existing *he*, or vice versa. The latter situation indicates that it was corrected either by the original or by a second scribe. It may be an *'alef* or a *he*, an *'alef* plus a *he*, or a *he* plus an *'alef*. Since *'alef* and *he* are interchangeable, it would have been a needless correction, unless the *'alef* or the *he* is added to indicate a Tiberian long *qamaṣ*; cf. המעלה (= המעלה, "the steps"; see #57, 12:4), a feature known from other sources.<sup>6</sup> But if this is so, why was the additional letter not engraved superlinearly, as the *lamed* and *yod* of השלשי (2:4), the *mem* of בימ (10:15), the *reš* of ראש (11:5), or sublinearly, as the *'ayin* of דמע (11:14)?

The first letter of this item is the prefixed preposition *bet* followed by a noun, as in over 50 items in the Scroll. The *bet* can be vocalized as -בּ-, -בְּ-, -בֶּ-, -בֵּ-, "in/at/by." If the attached noun is in the absolute state (common or toponym), it can also be vocalized as -בּ- (if possible, the next letter has a *dageš forte*), -בְּ-, -בֶּ-, the contracted forms of -בְּה-, -בֶּה-, -בֵּה-, respectively, "in/at/by the." Accordingly, בְּהַרְיָבָה or בְּהַרְיָבָה could mean "in/at/by a ruin" of a number of ruins, or "in/at/by the ruin," the only one at this place. The rendering "in/at/by a/the" reflects these possibilities. This distinction is

4 Pixner, 342 and nn. 1-2.

5 *The Dawn of Qumran*, 94; Wolters (reads בחרובה), 32-33; Garcia Martinez, 461; Beyer (adds that it is near Dok), 225; Vermes, 374; Wise, 191.

6 E.g., ברעהא (= בְּרָעָה, "with knowledge," 1QS 7:4) vs. יוֹרָה רָעָה ("he shall teach knowledge," Isa. 28:9); היהא לי (= הָיָה לִי, "he became for me," 1QISa; the Masoretic text has לִי יוֹרָה, Isa. 12:2). Licht cannot explain the meaning of the extra *'alef* of ברעהא (*The Rule Scroll* (Heb., 1965), 161 n. 4). According to Kutscher, *he* plus *'alef* and *'alef* plus *he* instead of the final *he* represent *plene* spellings for the final *a* sound. The feminine suffix יָה is occasionally spelled in the Isaiah Scroll as יָהא; e.g., עליהא (= עָלֶיהָ, "מבצריהא (= מְבַצְרֶיהָ, "אליהא (= אֱלִיָּהּ). See *LLBIS*, 351. Likewise, בְּנֵי סִיעָהא vs. בְּנֵי סִיעָא, "the Clan of Sia(ha)" (Ezra 2:44 and Neh. 7:47, respectively). In 4Q SAM-c the scribe wrote עליו, then wrote an *'alef* on top of the *'ayin*, and also placed an *'alef* supralinearly. See E.C. Ulrich "4Q Sam-c: A Fragmentary Manuscript of 2 Samuel 14-15 from the Scribe of the *Serek hay-Yahad* (1Q5)," *BASOR* 235 (1979), 1-25.

important, since the Scroll being a secret document, often the compiler(s) hesitated to reveal the precise information. Cf. the possible vocalizations of חָפּוּר, “is buried,” versus the imperative חַפּוּר, “dig” (see #17, 4:7).

The first noun can be read many ways: חָרוּבָּא (Allegro, Lurie), חָרוּבָּה (Pixner), חָרִיבָּא, חָרִיבָּה (Milik, Wolters, Beyer), חָרוּבְּהָא, חָרוּבָּהָא, חָרִיבְּהָא, חָרִיבָּהָא, חָרוּבָּהָא, חָרוּבָּהָא, חָרוּבָּהָא (with *he*), etc.

A heroic Jewish resistance against the Romans took place at חָרִיבָּה, the “Village of Harevah” (y. Ta’an. 4:5 [21b]), or חָרִיבָּה, חָרִיבָּה, the “Village of Haruvah” (Lam. Rabbati 2:2); also spelled as חָרִיבָּא (Gen. Rabbah 64:8). These variants correspond to three of the many possible readings of the Scroll, and may be identical with Haruvah in the Valley of Achor.<sup>7</sup>

The root חרב, “to dry, heat, desolate, ruin, attack,” represents at least two roots: חָרַב (cf. Arabic *ḥaraba*, “to plunder”) and חָרַב (cf. Arabic *ḥariba*, “be in ruins”).<sup>8</sup> Other possible meanings of חָרוּבָּה and חָרִיבָּה are “castle, palace, summer home, fortified place,” etc.<sup>9</sup>

The Hebrew verbal patterns of פָּעוּל (masc.) and פְּעוּלָּה (fem.) are the same as the Aramaic פָּעִיל (masc.) and פְּעִילָאָה (fem.; Hebrew *Qal - Pa'al*, and Aramaic *Pe'al*, pass. part. sg.). These patterns, also used as nouns and adjectives, are interchangeable with the nominal patterns of פָּעִיל and פְּעִילָאָה, and perhaps פָּעִיל and פְּעִילָאָה, both in Hebrew and Aramaic; cf. חָרוּץ vs. חָרִץ, “trench” (see #23, 5:8). Thus, חָרוּבָּהָא, חָרִיבָּהָא, and חָרִיבָּהָא (e.g., אֲשֶׁר חָרְבָּה יְרוּשָׁלַם חָרְבָּה, “that Jerusalem is in ruin,” Neh. 2:17), are interchangeable.<sup>10</sup>

7 Many toponyms contain the term חרב; e.g., חָרוּב, Haruv (y. Demai 2:1 [7a]); מִגְדָּל חָרוּבָּתָא, Tower of Haruv (t. Shevi. 4:11); הַר חָרֵב, Mount Horeb (Exod. 33:6, etc.); חָרִיבָּתָא, Ruins of the Lepers (b. San. 71a). Some of these are mentioned by Allegro (134 n. 1) and Lurie (53 n. 1). See also, Jastrow, 499; AC 3, 485-86. Klein suggests that Kefar Harevah/Haruvah was located southeast of Lod in Judea (SY, 92a-93b; cf. ETG 2, 41-44).

8 Cf. Ugaritic *hrb* (= חרב, fem.), “sword, large knife,” vs. *ḥrb* (= חרב, “to become dry” (UT, 398b [#893], 404b [#1000]; WUS, 106-07 [#963], 116 [#1078]). These show that two proto-Semitic sounds either merged into or are represented by a singular character in Hebrew (see M.Z. Segal, *Diqduq Lešon hamMišnah*, 33). For חרב the lexicographers list: one root (SB, 266-68); one root with two meanings (ESh<sup>con</sup> 1, 737-43); two roots (BY 3, 1729b-36b); two roots but one meaning (MK 1, 422-25); and three roots (BDB, 351-53).

9 Ben-Yehuda (3, 1735) claims that חָרְבָּה (Ezek. 33:27; Job 3:14) means “beautiful palace,” and it is related to the Arabic *hram*, ‘ahram, large buildings of the burial sites of the Egyptian rulers. Yehoash explains חָרְבָּה as “devastation,” “pyramid” (cf. Arabic ‘ahram), “palace” (cf. Arabic *mihrah*), or “summer home” (from חָרֵב, “summer”; Yehoash’s *Notes on the Bible*, 180b, 264b). BDB (352a) translates חָרְבָּה as “waste, desolation, ruin,” and so Mandelkern (423a). See also S. Daiches, “The Meaning of חָרְבָּה,” JQR 20 (1908), 637-39.

10 Several times in the Masoretic Text the *ketiv* is פָּעוּל while the *qeri* is פְּעִיל, and vice versa; e.g., קָרוּאִי (*ketiv*) vs. קְרִיאִי (*qeri*, Num 26:9); קָרוּאִי (*ketiv*) vs. קְרִיאִי (*qeri*, Num. 1:16; see Gordis, 117-19). Moreover, both patterns may occur in the same verse; e.g., “If a man has two wives, one אֲהוּבָה (is loved) and one שִׁנּוּאָה (is hated), and they, הָאֲהוּבָה, לְשִׁנּוּאָהָ (the loved one and the hated one), born him sons, and the first-born will be לְשִׁנּוּאָהָ (for the hated one)” (Deut. 21:15; Ibn-Ezra considers שִׁנּוּאָה as an adjective). According to

The following are additional possible readings, vocalizations, and interpretations for this problematic word.

הרובא, הרובא, הרובא, or הרובה may be variants of הרבה, Harabbah, a city in the Judaen Mountains (Josh. 15:60),<sup>11</sup> the *waw* may represent a Tiberian *pataḥ* (a similar case will be discussed later). Thus, בהרובה = בהרבה means "in/at/by Harabbah." Yet the first *he* may be a definite article, i.e., בהרבה, a non-contracted form of ברבה, "in/at/by the Rabbah"; cf. בשמים vs. בשמים, "in the heavens" (Ps. 36:6 and 2:4, respectively), בהשדה (*ketiv*) vs. בשדה (*qeri*), "in the field" (2 Kgs 7:12; see Radak).<sup>12</sup> רבה, Rabbah, "populous/great (city)," is a short form of בני עמון רבת, "Rabbah of the Sons of Ammon" (2 Sam. 12:26-27), i.e., the capital of Ammon.<sup>13</sup>

The compound relative-preposition שב- can be vocalized as שב-, שב-, שב-, "which is in/at/by," and when the noun is in absolute state, also as שב- (if possible, the next letter has a *dageš forte*), שב-, and שב- (contracted forms of שבה-, שבה-, שבה-, respectively), "which is in/at/by the." שב- appears 18-19 times in the Scroll, plus three times with suffixes.<sup>14</sup> In the Masoretic Text שב- occurs only twice: שבשפלנו, "which is in our degradation" (Ps. 136:23), and שבכרמים, "which is in the vineyards" (1 Chron. 27:27).<sup>15</sup> However, it is commonly used in Mishnaic Hebrew; e.g., הבור שבחצר, "the pit which is in the courtyard" (m. Miq. 3:2); השוקת

some, פעול implies temporariness, while פעיל permanence (e.g., A. Kahana, *Diqduq hal-Lašon ha'Ivrit* [1931], 44). Likewise, in Aramaic פעולתא - פעולתא and פעולתא - פעולתא are often interchanged. E.g., the Targum for תל עולם, "everlasting heap," is תל תרוב לעולם (TO, PsJ), "everlasting heap of ruin" (Deut. 13:17); and for עיר מצור, "besieged city," is לקריתא, "into the desolated city of Tyre" (Ps. 60:11). Jastrow (499a) lists together both forms, תרוב (masc.), תרוב (fem.), "ruined, desolate."

11 Rabbat Ammon was called Philadelphia in the Hellenistic - Roman period. It is the modern 'Amman, the capital of Jordan, located about 45 km northeast of Jericho (SB, 648).

12 Usually the definite article *he* assimilates into the prepositions of *bet*, *kaf*, *lamed*, which receives its vocalization. However, there are exceptions; e.g., וילקחם = וילקחם, "and for the axes" (1 Sam. 13:21, see Radak), ולגדוד, "for the troop" (2 Chron. 25:10) vs. בגדוד = בגדוד, "in the troop" (Job 29:25).

13 Rabbat Ammon was called Philadelphia in the Hellenistic - Roman period. It is the modern 'Amman, the capital of Jordan, located about 45 km northeast of Jericho (SB, 648).

14 שבמזרח (2:13), שבמגוז (6:14), שבינה (12:10), שבחצר (1:6, 2:5), שבדרך (8:1), שבמלח (3:8, 3:11), שבמצור (9:17), שבנרבך (alt., 1:5), שבנחל (5:12), שבסככא (5:5), שבשפון (4:11), שבשולי (9:14), שבשול (9:1), שבא (8:14), שבה (9:16), שבו (2:9).

15 The usual biblical form is אשר ב-; e.g., באשר ממרא אשר בהברון, "in the Terebinths of Mamre, which are in Hebron" (Gen. 13:18); שדה עפרון אשר במכפלה, "Field of Ephron which is in the Machpelah" (Gen. 23:17).

שֶׁבֶטֶלַע, “the trough which is (hewn) in the rock” (m. Miq. 4:5). Moreover, -שֶׁבֶטֶלַע and -שֶׁבֶטֶלַע are practically interchangeable with שֶׁל־, שֶׁל־, שֶׁל־, and שֶׁל־ (= שֶׁל־הַ). Cf. בִּיגְרוֹבִיגְר שְׁבִמְגוֹת הַכּוֹהֵן הַגָּדוֹל, “In/at/by a/the heap which is in/at/by (the) Bridge/Pass of the High Priest” (6:14-7:1), vs. בִּיגְרוֹבִיגְר שֶׁל גִּי, “In/at/by a/the heap which is in/at/by the Valley of Secacah” (4:13).

עֵמֶק, “valley” (from the root עֵמַק, “to be deep”), occurs 43 times in the Masoretic Text. In addition, עֵמַק is the first element of sixteen biblical toponyms; e.g., אֶל עֵמֶק שְׁוֵה הוּא עֵמֶק הַמֶּלֶךְ, “at the Valley of Shaveh, that is the King’s Valley” (Gen. 14:17; see #46, 10:5). Moreover, <ע>epths, “<d>epths,” occurs as an alternate reading in the Scroll (see #45, 10:3).

שֶׁבֶעֵמֶק עֶכּוֹר, “which is in (the) Valley of Achor/Disturbance,” is spelled later as שֶׁבֶעֵמֶק עֶכּוֹן, a *nun-reš* interchange (cf. חֶפּוֹן and חֶפּוֹר, see #17, 4:7). עֶכּוֹר, Achor, is from the root עָכַר (H, A), “to disturb, trouble.” עֵמֶק עֶכּוֹר, “Valley of Achor,” near Jericho appears five times in the Masoretic Text.<sup>16</sup> It was named after עֶכָן, Achan, who violated the חֶרֶם, “ban,” imposed on Jericho at the time of the conquest by Joshua.<sup>17</sup>

And Joshua took אֶת עֶכָן בֶּן יִרְחָ וְאֶת הַכֶּסֶף וְאֶת הָאֲדָמָה וְאֶת לְשׁוֹן הַזָּהָב (Achan the son of Zerah, with the silver, and the mantle, and the bar of gold) ... and all Israel was with him, and they brought them up to עֵמֶק עֶכּוֹר (Valley of Achor) ... And Joshua said, מָה עָכַרְתֶּנוּ? (Why did you troubled us)? The Lord יַעֲרֶךְ (shall trouble you) this day! ... And all Israel stoned him to death ... and they raised גִּל אֲבָנִים גָּדוֹל (a great heap of stones) over him (that remains) to this day ... Therefore, he called the name of that place עֵמֶק עֶכּוֹר (Valley of Achor/-Trouble) until this day (Josh. 7:24-26).<sup>18</sup>

And the sons of Carmi (were), עֶכָר עוֹכֵר יִשְׂרָאֵל אֲשֶׁר מָעַל בַּחֶרֶם (Achar, the troubler of Israel, who violated the ban; 1 Chron. 2:7).<sup>19</sup>

The latter is clarified by the Targum as, עֶכָר הוּא עֶכָן דִּיעַכַּר יִתְּ יִשְׂרָאֵל, “Achar is Achan, who troubled Israel” (*nun-reš* interchange). Since Chronicles names Achan as Achar, it is essential for the Targum to identify him.<sup>20</sup>

There are many references to Achan; e.g., כְּגִלּוֹ שֶׁל עֶכָן, “like (the) heap of Achan” (m. Oh. 15:7), alluding to the above verse.<sup>21</sup> Rav and Samuel

16 Josh. 7:24,26, 15:7; Hos. 2:17; Isa. 65:10 (see #24, 5:13; #54, 11:9).

17 See Josh. Ch. 7. See also, I.M. Casanowitz, *Paronomasia in the Old Testament* (1892), 39, 69 and n. 104.

18 The Mishnah discusses the execution of Achan (m. San. 6:2). The Talmudim raise the question, what was the sin for which Achor received capital punishment based on his own confession (y. San. 6:3 [20b-21a]; b. San. 43b-44a). Maimonides explains that it was due to הוֹרָאת שָׁעָה, unusual circumstances of that time (*Mišneh Torah, Hilkhoh Sanhedrin* 18).

19 (Pseudo-)Rashi, Radak, and *Mešudat David* elaborate on this verse why Achan is called Achar.

20 See also, A. Rahmer, *Targum šel Divrei hayYamim ...* (1866), pt. 1, 4-5; *Ein lateinischer Kommentar ... zu den Büchern der Chronik ...* (1866), pt. 1, 8. Cf. Josh. 22:20 and its Targum. Regarding חֶרֶם, see #43, 9:16.

identify Achan with Zimri.<sup>22</sup> One says, “(Since) his name was Zimri, why was his name called עֶכָן (snake)? שְׁעִיכָן (because he caused) the punishment for Israel’s sin” (b. San. 44b).<sup>23</sup>

The basic disagreement among the scholars is whether the first word in the Scroll is a common noun or a toponym. The first view is supported by the phrase בֵּין שְׁנֵי הַבָּתִּין שְׁבַעֲמָק עֶכָן, “between/among the two buildings which is in the Valley of Achon” (see #17, 4:6). The Valley of Achor/Achon, as Lurie points out, is located near Jericho.<sup>24</sup>

As noted above, both חֲרוּבָה and חֲרִיבָה mean “ruin, desolate (area).” Thus, בְּחֲרוּבָהּ/בְּחֲרִיבָהּ שְׁבַעֲמָק עֶכָן can be rendered as, “In/at/by a ruin which is in the Valley of Achor,” or “In/at/by the ruin which is in the Valley of Achor,” depending whether the first *bet* is only a preposition or it is a combination of a preposition and the definite article. The first case may indicate that this valley has were several ruins, and in one of them is hidden the reported cache, thus further limiting the information. According to the second possibility, the valley had only one ruin, thus the information is more specific. Since the Scroll is a secret and coded document, the first possibility seem to be the proper reading.

Finally, it possible to read the word in question as עָבוֹר (with a *bet*), “pass over” (from the root עבר, “to pass”), as Pixner and Garcia Martinez do, however, עָכוֹר (with a *kaf*) is a more plausible reading.

(1:2) תַּחַת הַמַּעֲלוֹת הַבּוֹאֹת, “below the steps that are coming/going” — Cf. תַּחַת הַמַּעֲלָה, “which is below the steps” (2:1), and =) תַּחַת הַמַּעֲלָה (הַמַּעֲלָה, “below the step” (sg., see #57, 12:4). תַּחַת הַמַּעֲלוֹת הַבּוֹאֹת is like the phrase וְעַד הַמַּעֲלוֹת הַיּוֹרְדוֹת, “and until the steps that are descending” (Neh. 3:15); both contains a preposition followed by two plural feminine forms, both prefixed with the definite article.

הַבּוֹאֹת, “that are coming/going,” is a non-standard spelling for הַבּוֹאֹת (*Qal* act. part. pl. fem. of the verb בּוֹא, “to come, go,” prefixed with the definite

21 See *Tif'eret Israel* on this Mishnah. גַּל occurs in the Scroll (1:11).

22 So is Rabbi Joshua ben Levi (y. San. 6:1 [20b]).

23 Rashi explains עֶיכָן on the basis of עֶכָנָא (A, same as עֶכָן, MH, “snake”) as, “like a snake that encircles (its prey) with a circular fence” (ad loc.). See Jastrow, 1079; AC 6, 198b-99a. The sin of Achan is discussed at various places; e.g., m. San. 6:3; t. San. 9:5; y. San. 6:3 [20a-b]; b. San. 43b-44b. Achan’s sin is also mentioned in an elegy (קִינָה) by Rabbi Eleazar Kallir (c. 7th cent. CE) recited on the Ninth of Ab, which commemorates the destruction of both Temples. The sixteenth line (letter ‘ayin, the initial letter of the name Achan) says, “But to us shame of face, בְּעֶכָן אֲשֶׁר מָעַל בְּהָרֵם (because of Achan who violated the ban) without finding an answer (to the charge).” See A.I.J. Rosenfeld, *The Authorised Kinot for the Ninth of Av* (1970), 123; B.Z. Schischa, *Seder Qinot ham-Mevo’arot leTis’ah be’Av* (1985/86), 136.

24 See also, Y. Safir, “עמק עכור” in *EB* 6, 298-99.

article acting as a relative). The *waw* may represent a Tiberian long *qamaṣ*, while the plural suffix *-ot* is spelled defectively; cf. *השקות* (Baker<sup>dr</sup>, Milik<sup>dr</sup>) for *השוקת*, vs. *השקת* (Allegro<sup>dr</sup>), “the sink” (see #49, 10:16).<sup>25</sup> This feature is known from the Dead Sea Scrolls,<sup>26</sup> *ketiv-geri* cases in the Masoretic Text,<sup>27</sup> Babylonian Aramaic Magical Texts,<sup>28</sup> Mishnah and Tosephta manuscripts.<sup>29</sup> The non-standard spellings are remnants of a non-Masoretic orthography. They represent dialects that differ from the Tiberian vocalization, and should not be confused with the full *plene* spellings, *כתיב מלא*, of the printed editions of the Midrashim and Talmudim.<sup>30</sup> Moreover, *הַבּוֹאֹת* for *הַבְּאֹת* resembles the Masoretic spellings of *הַטּוֹאֹת* for *הַטּוֹאֹת*, “sins” (e.g., 1 Kgs 16:13), *שְׁמֹאֹל* for *שְׁמֹאֹל*, “left” (e.g., 2 Kgs 23:8), etc.

One can read as *חֲבוּיָהּ* (cf. Lurie), a variant of *חֲבוּיָהּ*, “hidden”<sup>31</sup> (*Qal*

25 Cf. *כוּבָהּ* (= *כְּזָבָה*, alt.) where the *waw* may represent a Tiberian *mobile sewa* (see #32, 7:14-15). Also, *בְּהִרְבָּהּ* for *בְּהִרְבָּהּ* (alt.), as discussed above.

26 E.g., *רוּחָם* (1QS 5:21, 9:14) vs. *רוּחָם*, “their soul” (Judg. 8:3); *גְּבוּרָתָם* (1QS 1:21) vs. *גְּבוּרָתָם*, “their power” (Micah 7:16); *בְּבוֹאֵם* (1QSa 1:4) vs. *בְּבוֹאֵם*, “as they come” (1 Sam. 16:6); cf. *הַבּוֹאֹת* (1:2) vs. *הַבְּאֹת* (Gen. 41:35) - *הַבְּאֹת*, “which are coming” (Isa. 41:22). Thus, *waw* may represent a Tiberian *qamaṣ*. See J. Licht, *The Rule Scroll*, (Heb., 1965), 47; *The Thanksgiving Scroll* (1957), 9.

27 E.g., *בְּהִלְכָתָם* (*ketiv*) - *בְּהִלְכָתָם* (*geri*), “as they go,” Nah. 2:6); *גִּלּוֹן* (*ketiv*), Galon, vs. *גִּלּוֹן*, Golan (Josh. 20:8, 21:27); *הַפְּרוּזִים* (*ketiv*) vs. *הַפְּרוּזִים* (*geri*), “the villagers” (Esth. 9:19); *וְגִדְלוֹתְךָ* (*ketiv*) - *וְגִדְלוֹתְךָ* (*geri*) “and your greatness” (Ps. 145:6). The vocalization of a word may influence the next one; e.g., *אֵת מוֹצֵאֲךָ וְאֵת מְבוֹאֲךָ* (*ketiv*) vs. *אֵת מוֹצֵאֲךָ וְאֵת מְבוֹאֲךָ* (*geri*), “your goings and your comings” (2 Sam. 3:25); and *וּמְבוֹאֵי וּמְצֵאֵי*, “and its exits and its entrances,” instead of *וּמְבוֹאֵי* (Ezek. 43:11), cf. *וּמְבוֹאֵי וּמְצֵאֵי* (Ezek. 44:5), “to the entrance of the Temple, and to all the exits of the Sanctuary” (Ezek. 44:5). See B.M. Lewin, “וְזֶגְגְּתָם” in *Tachkemoni* 1 (1910), 25-38.

28 E.g., *רוּחֵינִי בִישׁוּתָא* (= *רוּחֵינִי בִישׁוּתָא*, “evil spirits” (Go:H:2); *לִישְׁמִיךְ* (= *לִישְׁמִיךְ*, “for your name” (Go:6:1). According to W.H. Rossell, the *waw* indicates that in Babylon the *qamaṣ* was pronounced as *o* (*A Handbook of Aramaic Magical Texts*, 14, 20-21).

29 E.g., *אוריח* (ms.) vs. *אריח* (pr. ed.), “half-brick” (m. ‘Eruv. 1:3). This term will be discussed later. Epstein lists many words from various manuscripts where *waw* represents long and short *qamaṣ* (*MNM* 2, 1245).

30 Many non-standard *ketiv* spellings in the Masoretic Text have parallels where there are no *ketiv-geri* cases, as well as in the Dead Sea Scrolls, in the Babylonian Aramaic Magic Bowls, and in better Mishnah and Tosephta manuscripts. The extra *waw*, where the Tiberian long *qamaṣ* is expected, indicates that the long *qamaṣ* might have been closer to *ḥolam* (*ow*) than to a *pataḥ* (*a*) as in the Yemenite and Ashkenazi pronunciations. Perhaps, *הַבּוֹאֹת* was pronounced like the Yemenite *habbo’owt*, Ashkenazi *habbo’ous* or *habbos*, rather than the Sepharadi *habba’ot*. Regarding unusual vocalizations, cf. *קוראים* instead of the expected *קוראים*, “(they) used to call” (Ps. 99:6), where the Masorah notes, *הא’ נָהָה*, “the ‘alef is silent”; and it is like the Mishnaic form *קורין* (e.g., m. Ber. 1:1), where the ‘alef is missing. According to Morag, many biblical words having non-standard vocalization represent a pronunciation that differed from the Tiberian system, and has an affinity with certain late- and post-biblical traditions (“On the Historical Validity of the Vocalization of the Hebrew Bible,” *JAOS* 94 [1974], 307-15).

31 Lurie, 53, 58.

